

ROBERTO GIOBBI'S

CARD

COLLEGE

LIGHT

PROFESSIONAL CARD MAGIC
WITHOUT SLEIGHT-OF-HAND

Card College

Light



Photo by Zakary Belamy

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Professional Card Magic
Without
Sleight-of-Hand

illustrated by
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Translated from the German by
Dave Shepherd



HERMETIC PRESS, INC.
Seattle, Washington

LYBRARY

www.lybrary.com

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Originally published in German as *Roberto Light*
by Magic Communication Roberto Giobbi.
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by Roberto Giobbi and Stephen Minch.
Ebook Mastering by Lybrary.com

Ebook published by Lybrary.com.
It is the digital version of the book published by
Hermetic Press, Inc., Seattle: ISBN 978-0-945296-54-6

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ISBN 1-59561-011-1

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Card College

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DEDICATED
to the members of the
Magic Club of Vienna (1908–88)
on the occasion of the eightieth birthday
of that club, and to all participants in the thirty-third
Congress of Austrian Magicians in Vienna, July 1988.

In memory of PETER HEINZ KERSTEN (1929–2003),
an enthusiastic interpreter and great promoter of magic.



Thanks

AS ALWAYS, as in all of my books and writings, thanks go first and foremost to my wife and friend, Barbara, for her excellent illustrations. These serve as oases in a desert of type, and they always say more than many words can.

I am grateful in many ways to Peter Kersten, who unfortunately died too soon: first of all, for his lovely foreword; second, for commissioning the original edition of this work, which he did as president of the Magic Club of Vienna for the Vienna Jubilee Congress in 1988, as a gift for Congress participants; but above all for always, through his friendship, encouraging me in my work.

I would like to thank Dave Shepherd, who undertook the task of translating my German text with enthusiasm and painstaking precision. In my opinion, he has admirably succeeded in adapting my words to the cultural idiosyncrasies of the English language while maintaining my “voice”—neither of these things being a self-working feat.

I also owe a debt of thanks to the three devoted and knowledgeable gentlemen who carefully proofread this text before the ink could set: Jason England, Mike Henkel and Newell Unfried.

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Last but not least, great thanks go to the best of all publishers, Stephen Minch of Hermetic Press, who once again undertook the risk of publishing a card book where there are already too many. His suggestions on historical annotations, technical detail and writing style make this book easier and more pleasurable to read.

Foreword

VIENNA, THE CITY in which J. N. Hofzinser laid the foundation for modern card magic, has always been a good home for this subtlest form of magical activity. Roberto Giobbi is certainly one of the most competent practitioners working in this area today. His profound knowledge of the relevant literature, his contact over the years with prominent experts in this genre, as well as his quality as an entertainer specializing in card magic, guarantee you routines and effects that have withstood the test of performance.

Moreover, his way of explaining the most difficult sleights and trick sequences, so that they can be understood by any reader, distinguishes him from many other authors in this area. Therefore, it is not only my great pleasure, but also my fondest wish, to be able to present this book to you. I very much hope that as many as possible of you might adopt tricks from these pages into your own magical repertoire!

Peter Heinz Kersten

Vienna, July 1988

The Presentation of Sleightless Card Tricks

*I like the outwardly simple, that hides
great inner complexity.*

Miguel de Unamuno

THE GERMAN EDITION of this book is now almost twenty years old. Published in 1988, it was my second book and appeared four years before the first volumes of *Card College*, my course on sleight-of-hand card magic. The widespread success of this early effort in Europe has been highly gratifying. I wrote the work now in your hands before tackling *Card College* because of my abiding fascination with structurally simple tricks that, if properly performed, have great impact. I'm also fascinated by the ability of simple secrets to offer enough complexity to make the piece challenging. These ideas were verified in several lectures I gave for magicians, in which I was consistently able to entertain and fool many of them with such tricks.

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For whom is this book intended? For beginners, of course—but by no means in total. This book was written for everyone who has always wanted to perform card tricks, but who didn't have the time necessary to learn complex routines, or the years necessary to master difficult techniques. In this age of calorie consciousness, we should not have to live without a low-tech diet of card magic. The routines presented here are easily digestible, to be sure; but for the public—and at times even for audiences of magicians—they are rich delicacies.

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So, yes, this book is certainly meant to give the beginner great tricks, to reveal to him or her the incredible world of card magic, to provide an appreciation of the elegance and complexity that lies behind the craft, to instill a desire to attain more, or—if content to stay at this level—to teach some of the best material, so that the student can do so in a dignified manner.

However, besides the beginner, this book is also directed at those who are already proficient in the craft. I will risk seeming immodest, though I hope not arrogant, by saying that *Card College Light* is in a class apart from other books that focus on sleightless card tricks. Although some of these books may occasionally feature material that is more original, when it comes to artistic considerations—in which the goal is to make the trick deeper, not wider, through interpretation, staging, communication and psychology—these books seldom even recognize such concepts. *Card College Light* strives to remain as simple as possible, but (as Einstein recommended) not any simpler, and at the same time to identify concepts and to open doors for those who look and listen. The sleightless trick is put into the context of artistic

card magic. Other books give card tricks that are “easy to do”, “self-working”. Although these books and *Card College Light* consider the same type of material, their approaches to it are clearly dissimilar.

Thus, the tricks described here are meant to serve not only the beginner, but also—or perhaps especially—the advanced and established card-magician who wishes to include in his performances from time to time a trick wherein the audience can stare relentlessly at the fingers without discovering a thing. It is precisely in technically challenging performances that a thoughtfully constructed sleightless trick (that is, one that is not recognizable as such) fits especially well. And then there are those spectators who can see every double card, or who look the performer in the eye and say that he is hiding a card in his hand. These persons are the very ones who can be thrown completely off the trail by a clever and competent sleightless trick. These people then can be convinced that you really can “make magic”.

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In selecting these tricks, I have consciously avoided anything that smacks of endless counting, adding of digits and other such abominable mathematical practices. In this regard, the respected American card-magician Dr. Jacob Daley once remarked, “If you take a card trick with three sleights, and replace the first sleight with a subtlety, you get a better card trick. If you replace the second sleight with another refinement, you get a small miracle. But when you replace the third sleight, then you usually get a mathematical atrocity.”

I would like here to emphasize one thing: I have not assembled these routines simply to sell books; rather,

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most of these come from my active repertoire. Infrequently, yet from time to time, I am successful in fooling even the most competent magicians with these tricks. This might be due in part to the fact that my magician friends expect technically difficult card manipulations from me; and they are consequently baffled when I never touch the deck.

xx “When a strong man uses weak methods, then weak methods can become strong—but when a weak man uses strong methods, then strong methods become weak!” In this Chinese proverb there is a grain of truth. For this very reason, the sleightless card tricks presented here can above all enrich the repertoire of the well-versed card technician; the handling of a true master can breathe life into a mathematically lifeless procedure. When a violin virtuoso plays the simplest beginner’s etude on a Stradivarius, it sounds completely different from the performance of the same piece by a beginner. For everyone who takes this book in hand and reads it, it is my wish that he might discover the Stradivarius of the magical arts: the deck of cards.

It is in this spirit that you will find frequent commentaries in sections I have called “Lest I Forget...” The reader who has certain basic techniques of card magic at his disposal will find that the addition of an occasional false cut or false shuffle can help to conceal the secret of the trick, and can increase its effectiveness considerably. I wrote my five-volume series on card technique, *Card College*, with the intention of showing the interested reader the high road to sleight-of-hand card magic, and in that series, those who are interested can discover the tools for making the material in this book even more deceptive.

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I have chosen each of these tricks so that it can be presented with any deck of cards of average quality. Most of the tricks can be performed under all performance conditions and at any time, without preparation.

Some of these tricks are in fact so baffling that even magicians may assume you are using a gaffed deck. For this reason, it is advisable, whenever possible, to use a borrowed pack. This not only lends the performance more of a magical quality, it also proves you to be a flexible magician, everywhere and always “ready”—should this be important to you. By performing these sleightless tricks, you can easily create for yourself a reputation as a magician who can really make magic, since you are not dependent on your own props, but instead can do amazing things with any object at any time.

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This book contains a number of tricks in which a spectator must remember a card that is later found. Such tricks are frowned on by some magicians, but I have found these are usually “magicians” who present “tricks” rather than artful magic. To have a card chosen and possibly signed is in fact one of the most direct ways of getting a spectator emotionally involved in what is happening. Moreover, most of these tricks are dressed in a story that arouses interest, and they guarantee that the person will experience more than a simple “pick-a-card” trick.

Instead of describing the tricks individually, I have put them together in groups of three. In this way they can be more easily memorized and can be presented without having to spend a lot of time thinking about them. Furthermore, each routine runs for the “correct” length of seven to ten minutes. Always bear in mind that the spectator will

hardly be as enthusiastic about card magic as you are. If you place excessive demands on your helpers and don't know when to stop, your performance will achieve exactly the opposite effect, and the spectator will say to himself, "Well, I've had enough of these tricks for a while." If, after performing a routine, you have the impression that the spectators *want* to see a couple more pieces, you can still present a second routine as an encore.

In each routine, I have endeavored to assemble tricks that contain different types of magical phenomena. This will provide variety and ensure that the spectators do not become quickly bored.

xxii I encourage all readers to modify the combinations in these routines at their discretion, as well as to find their own staging and to develop their own scripts. It is not my intention to sell pre-packaged programs, or to give the impression that everything must be done in this way and no other. I do not believe in dogma, certainly not when it comes to art. I have, however, described the entire staging along with a script, because certain principles, concepts and procedures are often imbedded there, and can, I believe, be better recognized in context. Once you search for and understand these principles, you can introduce them into tricks in your own repertoire. When you then study new pieces, you will recognize problems and will be able to formulate elegant solutions. This is one way to turn tricks into art. But one always needs to apply practice, thought and passion.

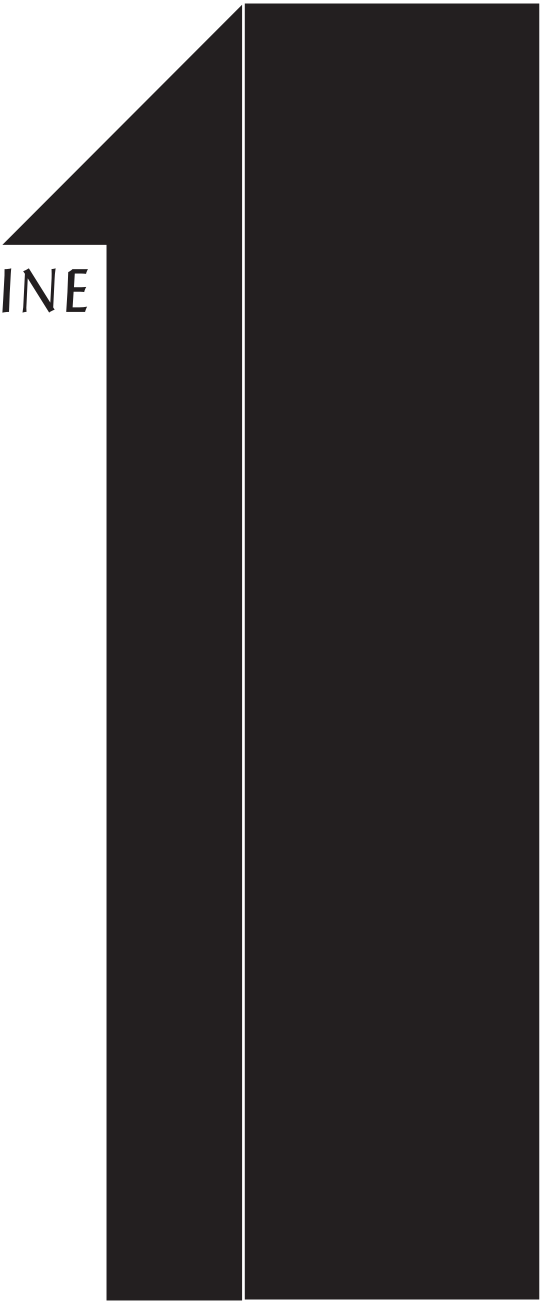
As I look, all these years later, through the newly typeset English text of this book, I still think the tricks are excellent and that I manage to open many doors to presentation and

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psychology that are necessary to protect the simple workings of these tricks while amplifying their effectiveness. In doing this, I instilled into these tricks much of my philosophy about what constitutes good magic, and many of my own interpretations and those I have learned from my masters, in life and in books, with the intension of teaching how good tricks with seemingly simple methods can be raised to a professional level of mystery and entertainment.

And now I wish you a fruitful study of the following pieces and principles.

Roberto Giobbi
*Basel, June 1988 and
September 2006*



ROUTINE

T.N.T.

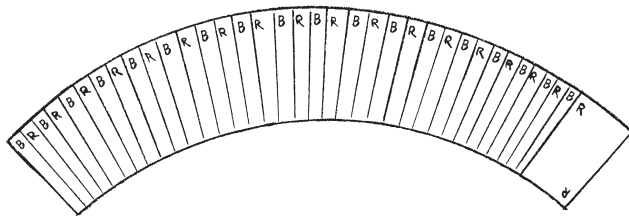
his trick carries all the potential power suggested by its title. It was created by the Spanish magical genius, Juan Tamariz.¹ After you have read the description and, ideally, have performed the trick, you will certainly agree with me that it is one of the best in this book! It is an ideal opener for our first routine.

Effect

The magician reveals two cards chosen in a way that would seem to make this utterly impossible.

Preparation

The deck is arranged in advance, with the red and black cards alternated.



The deck needn't be complete, but the number of black and red cards must be equal.

Staging and Handling

Set the deck on the table and have it cut by a someone. It can be cut again by the same person or another. Ask, *"Do you agree that no one here can know what card is on top?"* Wait for your helper to answer. *"Of course not, because you yourself cut the deck several times."*

Turn to someone sitting on your left. *"Please take the top card and thoroughly memorize it. Perhaps you can show it to some of your neighbors."* It is always advisable to have a chosen card noted by several spectators. This is insurance against forgetfulness or an occasional hostile intention. Fortunately, both of these happen rarely.

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Wait until the card has been noted. Then turn to someone on your right. *"And you, please: Take the next card, memorize it and show it to your neighbors."* While your two helpers are noting their cards, turn away, your body language making it clear that you are not interfering with the procedure or manipulating anything. As a matter of fact, you do not touch the deck until the end.

Turn again to your first helper. *"Please place your card back on top of the deck."* Turn toward the second helper. *"And you place your card on top of that one."*

You have just accomplished the only maneuver required for the success of this trick: You have exchanged the positions of the two top cards in a clever and subtle way that won't be perceived!

Ask your two helpers, *"Is there anything I could know about your cards?"* If you have presented everything in a convincing manner, the audience will have no choice but to

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answer, “No.” You immediately respond, *“Wrong! I do know something. I know that the two cards are on top of the deck.”* Look your helpers in the eyes and smile. *“Therefore, I’d like to ask you to cut the deck once more.”* Wait until one of them cuts the deck and completes the cut.

“Now I can’t know anything else about your cards, can I?” Wait for confirmation and reply immediately, *“Wrong! I know that they are approximately in the middle of the deck.”* The audience will have to agree. *“So I will turn away—you can keep an eye on me—and now please cut the deck again. Cut off a larger or a smaller packet—and complete the cut.”* After this has done, turn once again to the audience.

“Good. Now I certainly can’t know anything about your cards, do you agree?” The spectators will nod affirmatively. *“Wrong! I know that the two cards are together in the deck. So please pick up the deck and deal the cards onto the table, alternately to the left and the right, making two piles.”* Your helper does this.

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“So we now have two piles, and each of these must contain one of your cards, mustn’t it? And I absolutely cannot know where your cards are in each pile, right?” Wait for the answer and then exclaim again, *“Wrong! I know that the two cards must be at about the same level in each packet. If one of the cards is at the tenth position, then the other card must certainly be at the ninth, tenth or eleventh position, yes?”* The perplexed spectators will have to grant the truth of this.

Your audience by now will probably find your excessive honesty a little eerie. Most who have followed the action will already accept that the cards are lost. For those who think you could still exercise some control over the selections, the following will completely destroy any possible theories.

Turn to your two helpers who noted the cards. *“Therefore, I would like to ask each of you to take a packet and shuffle it thoroughly.”* They do so.

To help everyone remember, long after the performance, that the cards were mixed by members of the group, you can ask them to shuffle over their heads or behind their backs. This is a psychological touch Juan Tamariz often uses, and one that distinctly improves the remembered effect. Many people will later swear the cards were shuffled both beforehand and afterward. That is the intention.

6 *“Are you now convinced that the cards are thoroughly mixed? Good. Still, I will find your cards lightning-fast—that means, with approximately the speed of lightning.”* Take the first packet of cards and fan it with the faces toward you. It will consist wholly of cards of a single color, either red or black—with one exception. This exception is the first selection. Remove it from the packet as fast as lightning, as you have promised, and lay it face down on the table. Lay the remainder of the packet aside, face down. Pick up the second half of the deck, locate the second person’s selection in the same rapid manner and lay it face down beside the first selection.

You now only need to ask your helpers to name their cards, and then, in a dramatic fashion, very slowly turn the two cards face up, first toward yourself, then toward the spectators. They are the two cards chosen earlier!

If you now put the deck together by laying, say, the black cards onto the reds, the cards are separated into reds and blacks! Of course, you will put each of the two selections back into the half of the deck matching its color.

Lest I Forget...

1. This trick is a prime example of how one can use an intelligent construction and a thoroughly thought-out script to fool even an informed spectator.
2. The only risky moment occurs when the deck is dealt into two piles. If your assistant deals two cards instead of one, or fails to deal alternately to the piles, the whole trick goes down the drain. It is therefore preferable to give the deck to someone who can handle cards competently—a card player, for example—and to observe the dealing. Or you can deal the cards yourself. This last option has the added advantage that the dealing will go faster and that you can make a remark or two to the audience while doing it. When you must count or deal cards, it is always important to keep the level of interest and dramatic tension high, to avoid any boredom during the procedure.
3. At the beginning of this trick, it is always better, of course, if you can give the deck a false shuffle. Since it does not matter where individual cards are, but only that the black-red alternation is maintained, an advanced magician can use any of a number of false shuffles and cuts to preserve this arrangement. Perhaps the simplest method is to hold the deck in position for an overhand shuffle, and in seven shuffling motions run seven single cards from the top into your left hand, then throw the remainder of the deck onto the seven. Running any odd number of cards, done in the action of shuffling, will retain the

alternating order. It is best to follow this shuffle with another short one, in which you simply pull off about half of the deck and throw the rest on top. Immediately do a third shuffle in which you pull five single cards into your left hand and throw the rest on top. Finally, drop the top half of the deck onto the table and lay the remainder on top, which constitutes a simple cut. During the whole shuffling process, you should not look at your hands, but at the audience instead, while saying something appropriate. This false shuffle is simply a temporary solution for the beginner. With just a bit more effort, it is possible to learn more convincing false shuffles. (Perhaps one of the simplest complete-deck false shuffles is the G. W. Hunter false shuffle in *Card College, Volume 2*, page 259. A somewhat more difficult but completely deceptive method is the "Optical Shuffle" in the same book, page 260.)

Intuition

The arrangement of cards at the end of the previous trick makes possible this next one. No one will think at this point that the deck could be arranged. After all, the cards were shuffled by the spectators! The following version of Paul Curry's great classic "Out of This World" was created by the American magician John Kennedy.² After performing it for many years, I have introduced some of my own handling touches.

Effect

Through the power of intuition, two spectators are able to separate the shuffled deck into red and black cards.

Staging and Handling

Ask two spectators other than those who participated in the previous trick to help you with the next. One should be seated on your left, the second on your right.

Intuition

"This is in fact an experiment. I would like to give you the opportunity to test your intuition. Of course, I don't know how it will turn out." Hold the deck face down in your left hand. If you've followed the procedure in the previous trick, the black cards are on top, the reds are on the bottom. If you like, you can give the deck a false shuffle that keeps the colors separated (see point 3, page 7).

10 With your right hand, take the deck into position for cutting and drop the bottom portion face down into your open left hand. You should drop about a third of the deck—roughly twenty cards—but in any event, less than half, and give the cards in your left hand to your helper on your left. This is easy to remember: The participant on the left gets the red cards (just as in politics, yet completely different). Now drop a bit less than a third of the deck into your left hand, and give the cards remaining in your right hand to the helper on your right. This person will thus get approximately the top twenty cards, all of which are black.

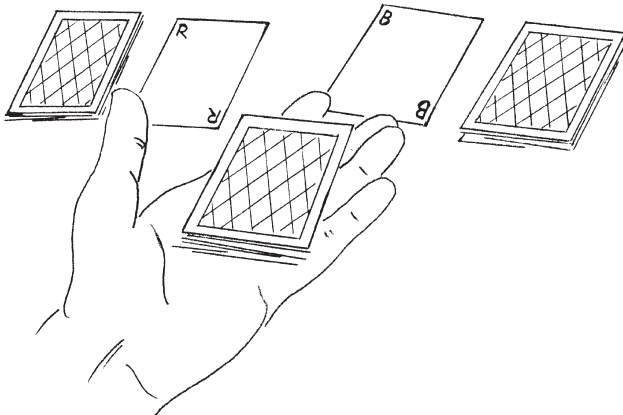
The two participants should shuffle their packets thoroughly, but not look at the faces or expose them to anyone, since they would immediately see the cards in each packet are all the same color. In a pinch, you could ask that they shuffle their packets under the table. Accompanying them, you shuffle your cards, and then fan them face up. Everyone will see the mixture of red and black cards. *"Each of us has approximately a third of the deck."* In fact, your helpers each have about twenty cards and you have maybe a dozen. No one will notice this, and in any case, it is irrelevant; but it is desirable that the spectators have more cards than you do, as it makes for a more impressive final picture.

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"We can assume that each of us has about as many red cards as black ones. Perhaps one has more spades than another, and perhaps the other has more hearts. Statistically speaking, this would be a coincidence." This is actually no lie; but in this case, statistics are on your side.

Turn toward the helper on your left, whom you know to have the red cards. *"I'd like you now to take the cards one at a time face down into your other hand. Through pure intuition, I'd like you to decide whether it is a red card or a black one. If you think the card is red, place it onto the table. But if you think it is black, place it here in my hand."*

Give the same instructions to the other helper, with one difference: He is to place onto the table the cards he thinks are black, and places the cards believed red into your hand. To aid in making their tasks clearer, place a red card from your packet face up in front of the left-hand helper and a black card in front of the right-hand helper. They will thus once again see the mixed condition of your cards and will assume that theirs are in the same condition. Lay your packet casually aside, face up, without squaring it, so that the cards can be seen to be mixed, should anyone look at them.

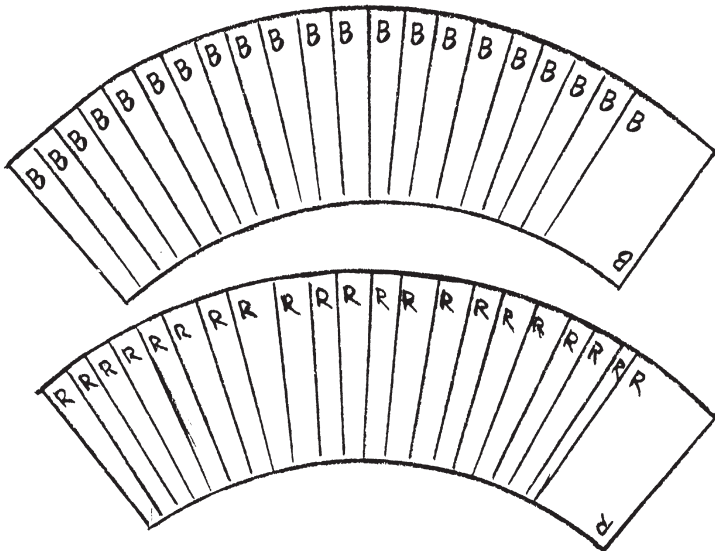


Intuition

The helpers follow your instructions, placing cards onto the table or into your hand. In our example, all the cards in the left-hand helper's packet are red, all those in the right-hand helper's packet are black, and those in the packet in your hand are a mixture of colors.

Once all the cards have been dealt out, turn the packet in your hand face up. *"No one could have known beforehand which cards you were holding and which cards you would place into my hand. As you can see, there are cards of practically every value here. And the red and black cards also happen to be completely mixed. It couldn't be any other way. But if you have done everything according to your excellent intuition, your cards are all one color, and your cards are all the other color!"* With these words, turn both packets face up and spread them on the table, ending the trick with an amazing climax. Congratulate the spectators on the remarkable intuition they have revealed and continue right on to the next trick.

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Lest I Forget...

Although, to one who knows it, the method might appear somewhat obvious, it can be largely concealed through intelligent construction. A synergistic effect of the whole routine is brought to bear: Remember, the spectators themselves mixed the deck in the previous trick. If at the finish you do not give the spectators too much time to think, and continue immediately to the next trick, you will find that they will be unable to reconstruct the sequence of events accurately.

The Telephone Trick

Tricks done over the telephone are particularly baffling, and in this age of cell phones they can be performed practically any time and any place. Most effects of this type demand a well-rehearsed team and a complex code that can only be mastered through constant practice. The following version³ is so easy a child could do it. It can be rehearsed with your partner (who is called the “medium” in the description) in as little as a minute.

Effect

The performer’s medium is called and is able to discern over the telephone the card freely selected from a shuffled deck!

Preparation

You will need a previously briefed medium who can be reached by telephone and who knows the simple code explained below.

Staging and Handling

Have the deck thoroughly shuffled while you explain that it is but a small step from the intuition just displayed by your two previous helpers to telepathy. A member of the audience takes any card. The selection procedure should be as dramatic as possible, so that it is totally clear to the audience that this is a free choice that could not have been influenced.

If enough people are present, the deck (or a portion of it) can be distributed among them. Then a person is chosen at random. For example, you can point to someone, who then points to someone else, and that person points to a third.

I often do it this way: I have the cards spread out face down on the floor. One person walks around on the cards while another whistles a melody. The instant the tune ceases, the pacing individual freezes in place. The card on which he is standing at that moment becomes the selection. Of course, there are countless other impressive methods.

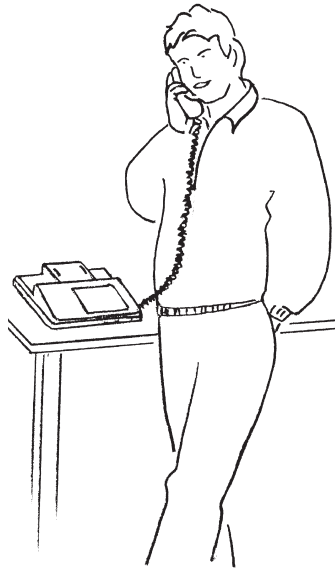
15

"I have a friend who is a fantastic mind-reader. If she were here she could tell you which card you are thinking of, just like that. But she also has the ability to read thoughts from far away. We'll call her now and ask her whether she can guess this freely chosen card."

Having made this statement, go to the telephone and call the medium. As soon as the person on the other end picks up the receiver, I would say, *"Good evening. This is Roberto Giobbi, the magician. Could I please speak with the medium?"* This is the cue for the medium to name the four suits: *"Hearts—spades—diamonds—clubs."* As soon as you hear the correct suit, say, *"Hello, is this the medium?"* The medium then names the thirteen card values, with

The Telephone Trick

a very short pause between them: "Ace-2-3-4-5-6-7-8-9-10-Jack-Queen-King." When you hear the correct value, you interrupt the medium, "One moment, please." Hand the receiver to someone who, at your prompting, explains the situation and asks the medium whether she can guess the chosen card. Of course, this is just a dramatic delay, since the medium already knows the card.



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The medium will, of course, not name the card straight out, but rather in steps, showing greater and greater intuition as she comes closer and closer to the identity of the card. If the chosen card was the Ten of Hearts, the dialogue might sound like this: *"Please point the face of the card toward all the audience members, so that they all can see it for at least two seconds. This will allow everyone to create a mental picture of the card. Thank you, that's enough. I feel certain that it is not a black card. Is that correct? All right, then it is a red card. I believe the suit has a round shape—a heart—there is a lot printed on the card—it looks like a picture card; a Jack or...no, wait...it's not a picture card, but I am seeing a high spot card—no, it's not an eight, it's not a nine—yes, I see it quite clearly now—it's a Ten of Hearts!"*

It is important that the person repeat each of the medium's statements loudly and clearly to everyone present. By doing this he will take on the role of a missing loudspeaker

that, if there were one, you could not turn on, at least in the beginning, due to the method of the trick. If the telephone has a speaker function, its use could “occur to you” after you have handed the telephone to your helper. From that point on everyone can listen in.

Lest I Forget...

It is, of course, better if it seems you do not know the card when you telephone the medium. There are, after all, always spectators who think you would use a code to convey the identity of the card to the medium. For this reason a well-versed card technician will have the card noted with a peek and then secretly glimpse it. Emphasize that the person is merely thinking of a card. For this reason, no one else should see the card. Give the deck to your helper and signal the name of the glimpsed card to the medium, as has been explained. When your helper is on the telephone with the medium, have him take his “merely thought-of” card out of the deck and hold it so that it can be seen by everyone in the room. One can also force the card, which eliminates the need to glimpse it, but the force must be very convincing. It is best to use the classic force. (A detailed description of this force can be found in *Card College, Volume 1*, page 217.) Presented in this way, the trick becomes an inexplicable miracle and serves very well as the climax of our first routine.



ROUTINE

Thot Echo

This trick is undoubtedly one of the most baffling location effects one can perform. The basic underlying idea was created by the American magician Sam Schwartz.⁴ This trick has never failed to fool every magician I've performed it for who did not already know the secret. The method is exceptionally clever. The fact that a bit of preparation is necessary puts you a few steps ahead of the game from the very start.

Effect

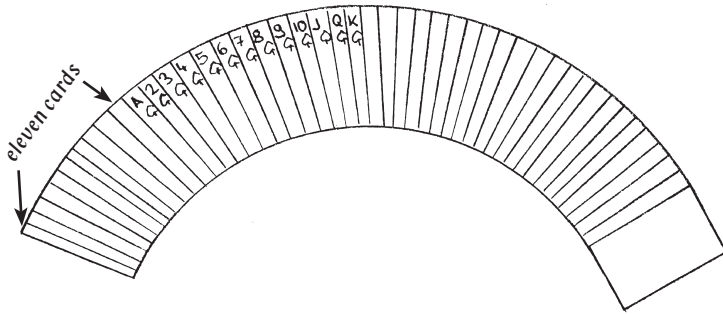
Someone selects two cards under the fairest conditions, and the magician succeeds in finding them.

Preparation

Remove the thirteen spades from the deck and place them in numerical order on top, so that the Ace of Spades is the first card, followed by the Two of Spades, the Three of Spades and so on. The King of Spades is thirteenth from the top. Next place any eleven cards

Thot Echo

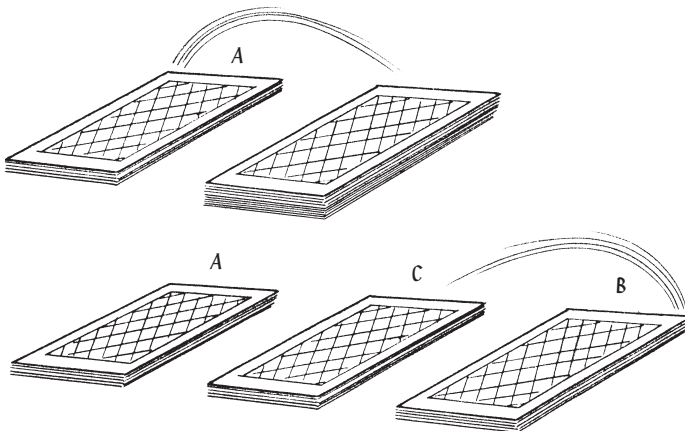
on top of the arranged spades. The Ace of Spades is now twelfth from the top, and you can begin the presentation of this extraordinary location effect.



Staging and Handling

Set the prepared deck face down in front of a spectator. To avoid confusion during this explanation, let's assume you and he are seated on the same side of the table, so that "left" and "right" are the same for both of you. During actual performance, it is usually better for communication if you sit opposite your helper.

Ask him to cut off about a third of the deck and to place it to the left of the remaining two-thirds (from his point of



view); in our description we will refer to this packet as A. Once he has done this, ask him to cut off about half of the larger pile and to place this packet, which we will call B, to the right of the two piles on the table.

Your helper has thus divided the deck into three approximately equal piles, with the bottom portion of the deck (C) in the center, the upper portion on the left (A) and the middle portion (B) on the right.

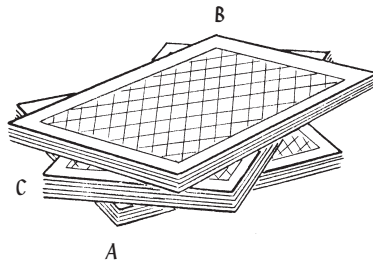
Point to Pile A and explain, *"This was originally the upper part of the deck. If I were to ask you to remember the top card of this packet, you could say I knew the card in advance."* Point to Pile C. *"This was originally the bottom part of the deck, and I could also know some cards in that part."* Finally, point to Pile B: *"But this packet is from the middle of the deck, which you have cut yourself. Is that right? So there is no way I could know how many cards are there—and I also cannot know which card is on the top or the bottom, isn't that true?"* Wait after each question for your helper to confirm your claims. Have him now take Pile B—the one to his far right (the original middle portion of the deck)—and ask him to remember the top card. We will assume this is the Six of Spades. Have him show this card to several persons around him. Next ask him to put this card anywhere in the middle of Pile B, and then to thoroughly mix this pile. When he has done this, have him put the packet back on the right end of row.

What has happened? If your helper has cut the deck into three packets of approximately equal size, the bottom part of the spades sequence will be uppermost on the packet cut from the center (B). Accordingly, he will have noted the lowest-value spade in this packet.

Thot Echo

Point to Pile A and observe to another person that this was originally the top part of the deck, and that it might be possible for you to know the top card. For this reason she is now to take Pile A and thoroughly shuffle it. When she has done this, tell her to *"Please note the card that random chance has brought to the top."* After she has memorized the card, have her return it to the top and place the packet back on the left end of the row. We will assume she has noted the Two of Hearts.

24 Continue by giving your helper the following instruction: *"Please pick up this pile [indicate C]. That was originally the bottom part of the deck. Perhaps you think I could know a card in this packet. For that reason I would like you to shuffle those cards thoroughly. I can't know how many cards there are in the packet, since you cut the deck. And I cannot know the position of any card, since you have just shuffled the packet. Place that packet on top of this pile [indicate A], which has the second noted card on top of it—a card that is now being hopelessly lost in the deck."* Finally ask her to place Pile B onto the rest, reassembling the deck.



If you like, and if the situation allows it, you can at this point remind the audience how entirely fair the selection procedure was, as well as the loss of the two cards back into the shuffled deck. In any case, emphasize that your helper shuffled each packet herself. (True!)

Pick up the complete deck and fan the cards from left to right with their faces toward you. In the upper third (the

leftmost part of the fan), look for the lowest spade among those spades you find there. (In our example it was the Six of Spades.) This will be the first noted card. Lay it face down on the table in front of the first helper.

To find the second card, you must add ten to the value of the spade you have just laid down. In our case, the result of this addition is sixteen ($6 + 10 = 16$). The sixteenth card from the face of the deck must be the second chosen card. Remove this card from the deck in the same fashion you did the first and lay it face down beside that card. While you have been looking for these two cards, secretly bring the five cards of a royal flush in spades (the Ten, Jack, Queen, King and Ace) to the top. (The order is unimportant.) This is easy to do and can often be accomplished with a simple cut, since the spades were earlier together in order.

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Have your two helpers now name their cards in a loud, clear voice. After a short pause turn the two cards face up. They are the selections!

Lest I Forget...

1. It is advisable to have the cards chosen by two helpers to avoid forgetfulness or confusion. In addition, you should always have the cards shown to others in the audience.
2. This clever trick is best suited for a performance before a smaller group, since you must have full and continuous control of the audience's attention. In this sense, it is a difficult trick. The wordiness of the presentation is necessary, in my opinion, to guide the audience's thoughts in certain directions, to eliminate possible solutions in advance and to lead the

Th o t E c h o

spectator to the conclusion that he has just experienced something that was absolutely impossible. And is it not the goal of magic to elicit in the mind of the spectator this emotion of the impossible, perhaps even of a miracle?

Royal Flush

A

lthough this trick has a poker theme, it can be performed for an audience that has little or no knowledge of this game. The impossibility of the climax is so visually obvious that the effect is strong for everyone. The basic principle was pioneered by the American magician Bob Hummer and has multiple uses.⁵ (This trick was shown to me by the late lamented Larry Jennings during my visit at the Magic Castle in June of 1986.)

Effect

Ten cards randomly chosen by a spectator are thoroughly shuffled by him and then dealt into two poker hands. The magician's hand is shown to be a royal flush!

Staging and Handling

At the end of the previous trick the cards comprising a royal flush in spades are in a random

Royal Flush

order on top of the deck. Hand the deck to someone and ask him to count ten cards, one by one, into a face-down pile.

The rest of the deck can be set aside, since it will not be used for this trick. Make sure the five cards of the royal flush are well distributed in the packet. Usually it is not sufficient to have the packet merely shuffled. An overhand shuffle, which is what laypeople usually use with a small packet, will not mix the cards sufficiently. For this reason you should scatter the cards on the table and ask your helper to mix them completely.

28



When he is convinced that the cards have been thoroughly mixed in this way, have him push them back together and hand you the packet.

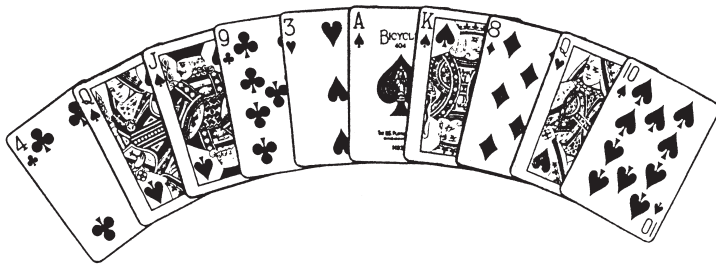
"We will now shuffle the cards in an even crazier way, so that they really are completely mixed up." With these words, turn the packet face up and spread the top three

CARD COLLEGE LIGHT

or four cards to the right. No matter what the random order of the cards, you will lay out five pairs of cards haphazardly. But what is not haphazard is that the spades in the royal flush are arranged in back-to-back pairs, and that the indifferent cards are paired face to face. You will be able to do this twice. There will be one pair left over, consisting of an indifferent card and a card from the royal flush. Holding these two cards face up, lay the royal flush card onto the indifferent card and drop them onto the eight dealt cards, either face up or face down—it doesn't matter.

To clarify the procedure, let me play out an example for you. Let's assume these are the ten cards you are holding after your helper has mixed them, from the face to the back of a face-up fan: Ten of Spades, Queen of Hearts, Eight of Diamonds, King of Spades, Ace of Spades, Three of Hearts, Nine of Clubs, Jack of Spades, Queen of Spades and Four of Clubs.

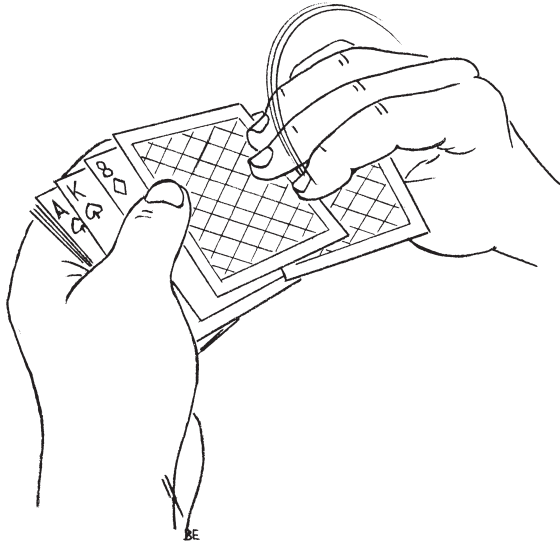
29



Begin to spread the cards in your hands and place the Queen of Hearts and the Eight of Diamonds face to face by taking the top two cards together into your right hand, turning that hand palm down and pushing the Queen of Hearts (now the top card) face down onto the face-up

Royal Flush

Eight of Diamonds. Then slide the Ten of Spades, held in your right hand, face up under the Eight of Diamonds and



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drop the top pair of cards onto the table. The Ten of Spades is now on the face of the left hand's packet, followed by the King of Spades. Put these two cards back to back and drop them onto the pair of cards you have just set on the

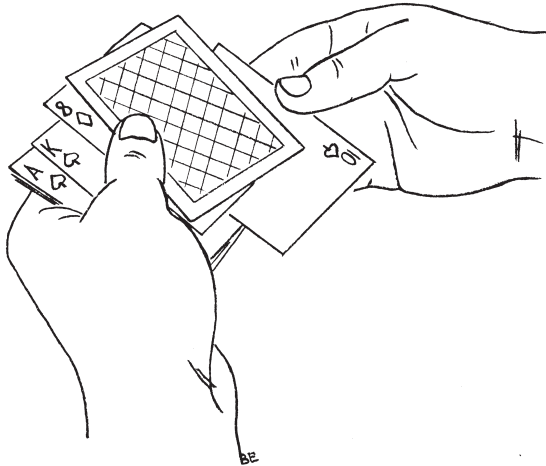
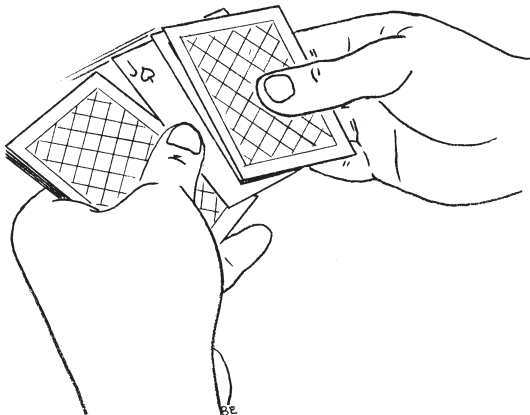


table. It doesn't matter which spade is on top and which is on the bottom. Continue spreading and set the Three of Hearts face to face with the Nine of Clubs, which you then drop onto the four cards on the table. Set the Ace of Spades and the Jack of Spades back to back and set this pair onto the tabled pile. The Queen of Spades and the Four of Clubs remain in your left hand. Keep the Queen face up on top of the face-up Four. Drop this last pair onto the tabled packet; it makes no difference whether it lands face up or face down. You are finished.

You can now have the packet cut by a spectator any number of times. For example, you could do this: Set the packet in front of someone and ask him to cut it. Complete the cut, turn the packet over and set it in front of another person, whom you ask to cut it again. This changes nothing, of course, but it looks very convincing.

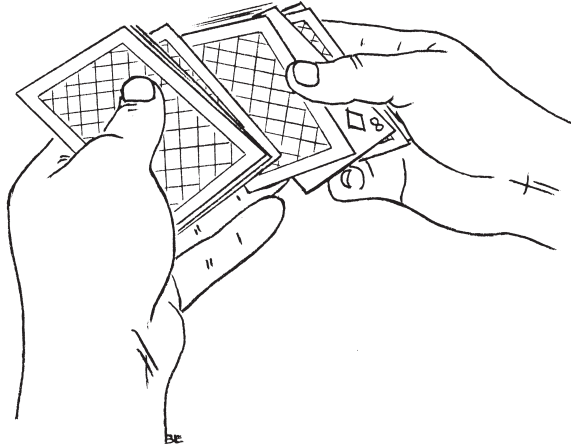
31

If you have mastered the Charlier false shuffle, you could use it between each cut. Here is a brief description: Hold the packet in left-hand dealing position. With your left thumb, push three or four cards to the right and take them into your right hand. Separate your hands and with your left



Royal Flush

middle and ring fingers, push some cards from the bottom of the left hand's packet to the right and take them on *top* of the cards in your right hand.



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Continue by pushing about half the cards from the top of the left hand's packet to the right and take them *under* the right hand's cards. Place the rest of the cards on top of the cards in the right hand. With this shuffle, you have merely given the packet a single cut. You may repeat the shuffle a few more times, always remembering not to look at the cards, but to keep talking as you look at the audience. It is best if you turn the packet over after every shuffle, so that the packet is "shuffled from both sides," which looks even more haphazard. Although a nice addition, this shuffle is not absolutely necessary.

Now ask your helper to take the packet and deal the cards alternately left and right, into two piles. Next turn over the pile containing the face-up royal flush cards and have your helper riffle shuffle it into the other pile. The cards can now be shuffled with either an overhand or a riffle shuffle, as many times as you like. This all takes place under the pretext of

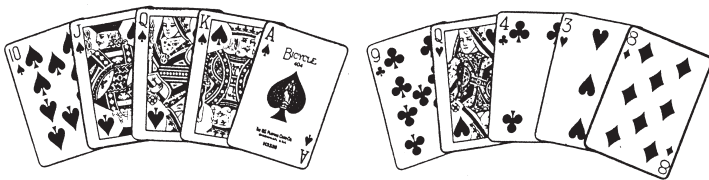
CARD COLLEGE LIGHT

mixing the cards even more thoroughly. Since this shuffling procedure is in fact completely free, the spectators will later remember that they themselves shuffled a group of randomly chosen cards from the deck in a totally chaotic manner. This makes the following double effect even stronger.

Hold the ten-card packet so that the royal flush cards (which thanks to Bob Hummer's parity procedure now all face the same direction) are all face down. Turn to a spectator and say, *"With these ten cards, which you yourself took from the deck and have shuffled several times, we are going to play a game of poker. Which cards would you like, the face-up ones or the face-down ones?"* No matter how he answers, deal the face-down cards into one pile and the face-up cards into another.

The first effect consists of the fact that, in spite of all the shuffling, exactly five cards are face up and five are face down; that is to say, one hand is showing and the other is hidden. After pointing this out, you remark, *"Although you may not be so astonished by this situation, I assure you that a configuration like this is mathematically very improbable."* This is true. Comment on the hand of face-up cards. Usually it will not contain anything significant. If a good hand is showing, in spite of expectations, play up the situation as an additional effect and congratulate your helper on choosing and shuffling such good cards. *"Recently, someone said to me, 'I wouldn't like to play poker with you.' I know exactly why...."* With these words, lay out the royal flush in spades.

33



Royal Flush

Lest I Forget...

As with all tricks of this type, a false shuffle and false cut at the beginning, before your helper counts ten cards onto the table, can be very convincing. You can, of course, choose any other suit for the royal flush; however, in my opinion spades look best because of the large Ace pip. Moreover, many laymen have the false belief that spades rank highest in poker. Since we are polite, we will not refute this; instead, we will merely exploit it.

The Waikiki Shuffle

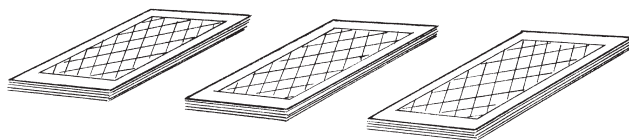
The following trick is both an unusual and an original method of locating a chosen card. The principle used in this trick is called the “Waikiki Card Location”, and was invented by Bill Murata.⁶

Effect

A subconsciously controlled swing of a pendulum reveals the identity of a chosen card to the performer.

Staging and Handling

Borrow a ring from a female spectator and tie it to a thread or a string. In trade, give her the deck and request that she shuffle it thoroughly. When she has done this, have her cut the cards into three packets

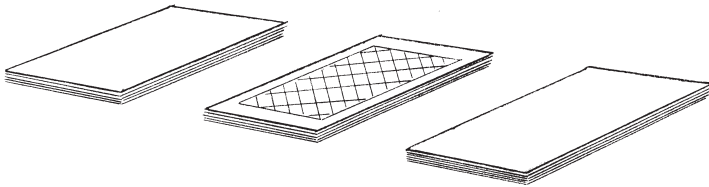


The Waikiki Shuffle

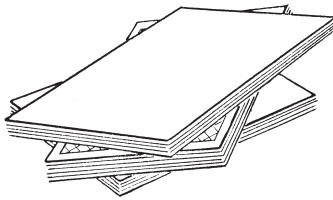
of approximately equal size, laying them out in a row in front of her.

Turn your head away and ask her to note the top card of one of the three piles, and then to replace the card onto the same pile. Let's assume she chooses the middle pile and that the card she looks at is the Four of Spades.

Ask her to turn the other two piles (those not containing her card) face up.



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Then have her gather the piles, burying that with her card face down between the other two, and to square up the deck.

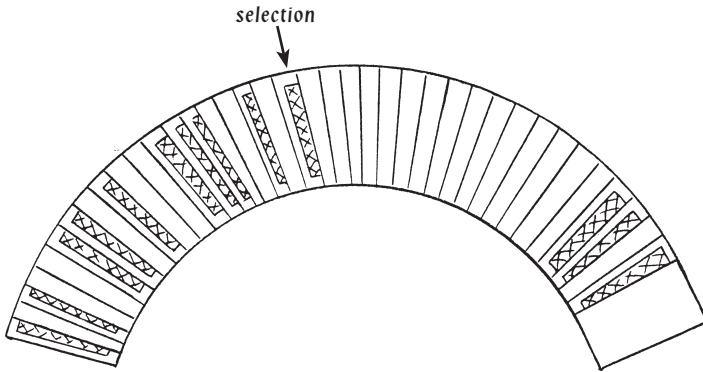
After she has done this, ask her to cut the deck near center and to riffle shuffle the halves together. This will result in a mixture of face-up and face-down cards, and your helper's selection seems impossibly lost.

If she is unable to do a riffle shuffle, you can do the weave for her and let her push the interwoven cards together at the end. Later, when thinking back over the course of events, she will at least remember the feeling of have shuffled, which is associated with pushing the cards square. Of course, the trick is far more effective if your helper does everything herself, while you turn your back.

She can now make and complete as many simple cuts as she likes.

CARD COLLEGE LIGHT

Turn toward the audience again, take the deck and ribbon spread it from left to right. You will notice a long sequence of face-up cards in the spread. The first face-down card to the left of this sequence is the selection!



It is possible that your helper will separate the sequence of face-up cards as she cuts the deck. If this occurs, there will be a smaller sequence of face-up cards on the left and right ends of the ribbon spread. In this case the chosen card is, logically, to the left of the face-up sequence on the right end of the spread.

Now hold your improvised "pendulum" (your helper's ring on the string) over the spread and use it—along with "the power of your subconscious and your latent ideomotor sensitivities"—to divine her card.

Lest I Forget...

1. Once you understand this principle, you can spread the cards in your hands, rather than in a ribbon spread. In this instance, even an extremely attentive spectator cannot notice that you take the first face-down card after a long face-up sequence.

The Waikiki Shuffle

2. Here is another clever way to handle this location: As you take back the deck, turn it over and ribbon spread it from left to right. The selected card will now be the first face-up card to the right of the longest face-down run of cards. You can see it as you are still spreading the cards. Immediately mix them up with both hands on the table and ask several spectators to help you. You can even ask them to turn bunches of cards over as they are mixed. In the end, the audience will remember that the card was selected and replaced under the most impossible conditions. You can now gather the deck, turn it so that the selection is face up and, since you know the card, proceed to reveal it in any way you please.

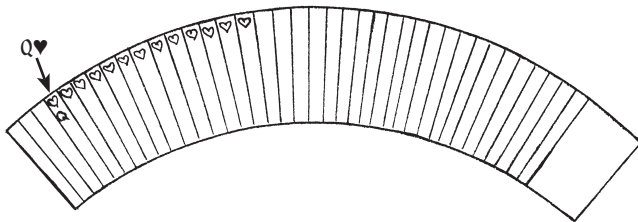


ROUTINE

In this routine a partially arranged deck is used, the arrangement of which is concealed by a time delay. It is more than understandable that even magicians cannot follow this stratagem.

Preparation

Remove all the hearts from the deck and place them in any order on top of it. Memorize the top heart. It will be your key card. For this explanation, we will assume it is the Queen of Hearts. Place three indifferent cards on top of the Queen.



Fingertip Sensitivity

In “Royal Flush”, above, we used a clever principle by Bob Hummer, known as the CATO principle (**C**ut **A**nd **T**urn **O**ver).⁷ The first trick in our third routine is based on the usual handling of this principle and is another excellent example of how one can achieve a baffling effect with very little effort.

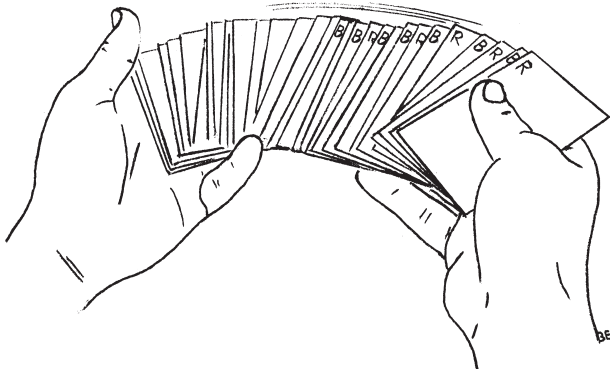
Effect

The magician divines the actions a person performs with a packet of cards under the table.

Staging and Handling

Take the deck and fan it with the faces of the cards toward you. Let’s assume a red card is on the face of the deck. In such a case, you take one of the nearest black cards and place it onto the red one. Spread the cards a bit further and take another red card, which you place onto the black card at the face of the deck. Continue this way until you have at least twelve cards that alternate red and black.

Fingertip Sensitivity



Count twelve cards from the face of the deck into your right hand and lay the rest of the deck aside; it will not be used in this trick. (On top of the deck, undisturbed, are the sixteen cards you arranged beforehand, which you will need for the next trick.)

44

If arranging the cards on the face of the deck is difficult for you, you can place red and black cards alternately into a face-down packet on the table. It is perfectly all right if the spectators see that you take particular cards from the deck.

Pick up the packet and have it cut several times. If you have mastered the Charlier shuffle, you may certainly use it here (see page 31; you will also find a more detailed discussion in *Card College, Volume 5*, page 1110). The only important thing is that the sequence of alternating colors is not disturbed. The identities of the cards play no role, and it doesn't matter whether the sequence begins with a red or a black card.

Explain to the person sitting across the table from you: *"Hold the packet of cards under the table, cut it anywhere and complete the cut. Turn the top two cards face up, leave them face up—and cut the packet again. Now once more turn the two top cards over and cut the packet. Repeat this*

CARD COLLEGE LIGHT

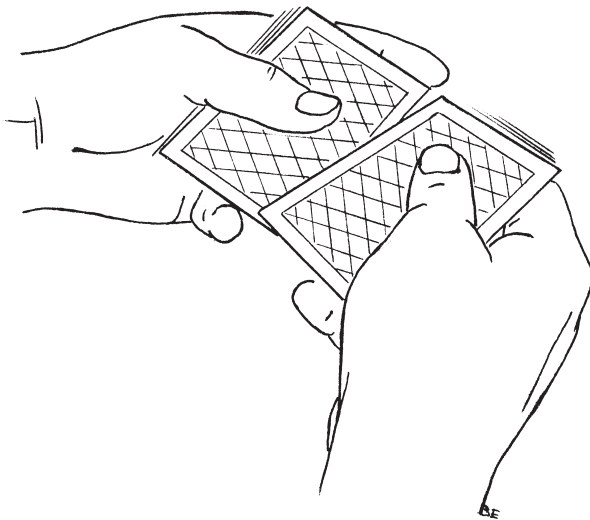
procedure again, a couple of times. Now please turn the entire packet over and turn the two top cards over. Cut the packet and turn the top two cards over again. Keep doing this until you are convinced that no one could know how many cards are face up and how many are face down."

After your helper has done all this, have him hand you the cards, which you, too, hold under the table. While taking the cards, turn your head clearly away from the action, so that no one can accuse you of secretly noticing the number of face-up cards.

"You must admit that I cannot know where you cut, I cannot know how many times you cut, and I certainly cannot know exactly which cards you turned over. Nevertheless, with the special sensitivity of my fingertips, I will try to make a statement about the condition of your cards."

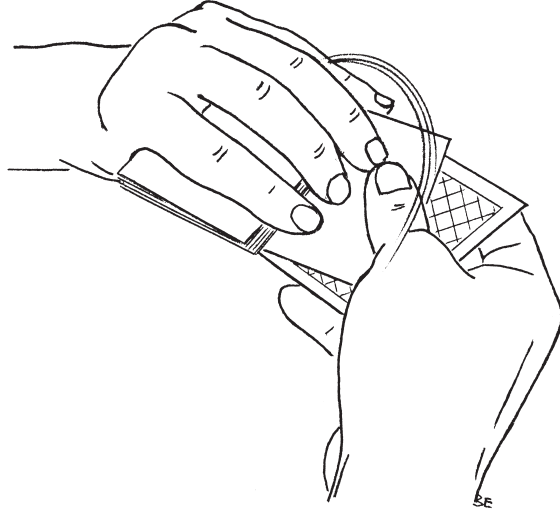
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While you are saying this, you hold the cards in left-hand dealing position and push the first card into your right hand, which takes it into reciprocal dealing position.



Fingertip Sensitivity

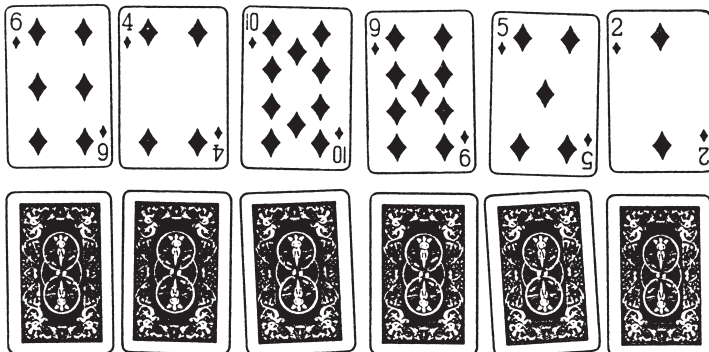
Turn your left hand palm down and, with the left thumb, push the next card onto the first one in the right hand. This turns the card over. Turn the left hand again palm up and



46

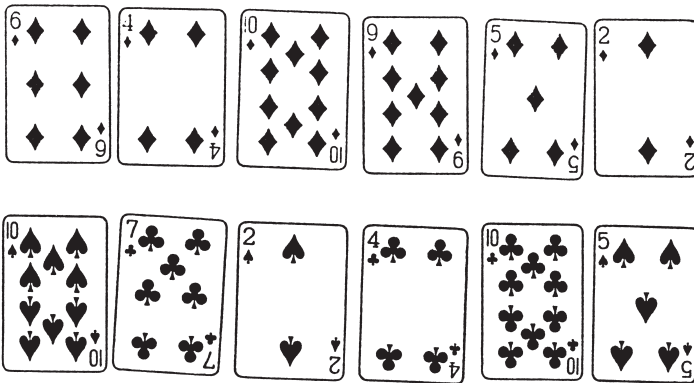
push the next card onto the right hand's two cards. In this way, alternating the left hand palm up and palm down, transfer all the cards from the left hand to the right.

Place the packet onto the table. "Now there are exactly six cards face up and six cards face down." With these words count the cards onto the table, laying the face-up and face-down cards into two respective rows.



CARD COLLEGE LIGHT

Wait until the effect has sunk in; then remark, *"Moreover, I have found all the red cards."* If the black cards are face up, change your claim accordingly. Wait a couple of seconds, since there will certainly be one or two spectators who think you took nothing but red cards from the deck in the beginning. At exactly the moment the uncharitable have formulated this impolite notion, turn the six face-down cards face up and show that they are in fact six black cards!



47

We now come to the second phase of the trick, which presents an even more inexplicable event. Have your helper pick up all twelve cards and shuffle them. Next, take the cards from him, hold them under the table and push them alternately face up and face down into your right hand, as explained above. When the cards have been "prepared" in this way, bring them above the table and hand them to the helper, asking him to put them again under the table.

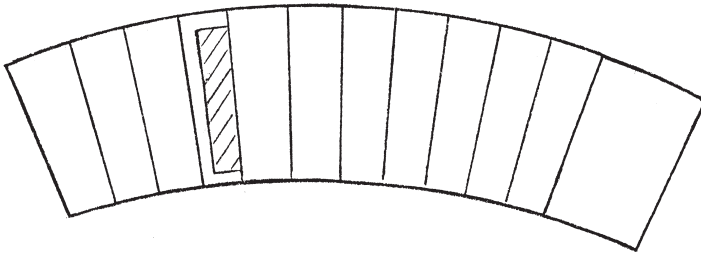
His next actions are truly governed by chance. *"Cut the packet and turn the top two cards over. Just as before, you may do this as long as you like. Then turn the entire packet over and do the same thing on the other side."* Your helper does this. *"Now cut the packet again. Hold the cards so that*

Fingertip Sensitivity

you can see them under the table. Now there are two possibilities—either the top card is face up or it is face down. If it is face down, turn it face up, remember the card, leave it face up on the packet, and cut the packet once. If it is face up, remember the card, turn it face down onto the packet and cut the packet once. When you have done this, you can give me the cards.”

Hold the packet once more under the table, push the cards alternately face up and face down into your right hand, as previously explained, and place the packet onto the table. Ask your helper to name for the first time the card he remembered. Snap your fingers and spread the cards face up on the table. A single card is seen face down. Turn it over—it is the freely chosen card!

48



Lest I Forget...

1. The basic mathematical principle in play is so astounding, you will probably fool yourself the first time you try it.
2. In the context of this routine, all the red cards will be diamonds, since the entire hearts suit is on top of the deck, awaiting the next trick.

Muscle Reading

Have no fear; in this trick (my interpretation of a brilliant location by California's Jack McMillen ⁸) you do not really have to know how to muscle read. However, it serves as a thoroughly plausible pretext for the staging of the trick. I will leave to your judgment and your style of performance as to whether you wish to present the phenomenon of muscle reading as "real" or with a wink. Those who represent it as genuine may make a stronger impression; those who present it with humor will often come across as more likeable. No matter which style you choose, I believe it necessary that the audience finds you interesting as an individual—and this is one of the most important objectives one can achieve with simple cards tricks, presented well and with talent. If the audience thinks you are interesting, you can perform practically anything—as long as you *present* it well.

Muscle Reading

Effect

Someone chooses any card, then shuffles it thoroughly into the deck. Thanks to the magician's ability to read this person's unconscious muscle impulses, he is able to successfully find the card.

Staging and Handling

Take the portion of the deck you set aside earlier and drop it onto the twelve cards you've just used in "Fingertip Sensitivity", making the deck once more complete. Reach into your pocket and take out two imaginary dice.

50 *"I would like to give you this pair of dice. They are imaginary dice. You can only see them if you have a good imagination. Whoops, you dropped one. I'd like you to roll the dice once and add up the numbers they show."* Ask your elected helper for the result, which we will assume is eight. Have her roll the invisible dice again and name the result, which we will say is five. *"You see, they aren't loaded. They produce different numbers every time you roll them."*

The dice are a good method for limiting the choice of a number between two and twelve in a natural way—exactly what we need. This is much better than simply asking the person to think of a number between two and twelve without any justification for the limited range.

Retrieve the dice and demonstrate what you wish your helper to do next. *"For example, if you roll a two and a one, the result is three. You will then take the deck and deal three cards, one by one, into a pile on the table, look at the top card of the deck, and put the dealt cards back on top of the deck."* With these words you have dealt off the three indifferent cards above the sequence of hearts. Point to the top card of the deck without looking at it; you do not

want the spectators to believe you could know a card. Pick up the pile and point to the deck with it to indicate that the pile of dealt-off cards should be placed back on top of the deck. However, instead of putting these cards onto the deck, you insert them into the middle as you explain, *"In this case, I'll put them back into the deck, since we have used them already."*

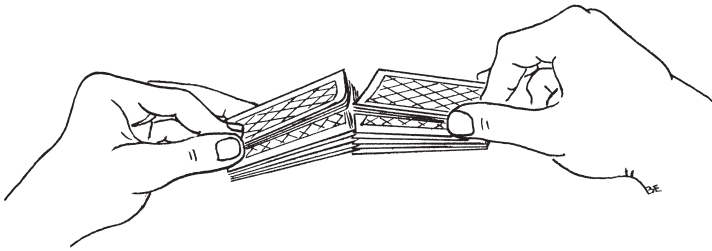
You have thus not only elegantly brought the arranged section of thirteen cards to the top of the deck, in readiness for the trick; you have also used a demonstration to assure that your helper understands exactly what he is to do. In tricks of this kind, this is an instructive factor you must not overlook. Here is a situation check: The Queen of Hearts should now be on top of the deck, followed by the remaining twelve hearts.

51

Hand the deck to your helper and have her roll her imaginary dice, noting the resulting number. Let us assume it is nine. Turn away beforehand, saying, tongue in cheek, that you do not wish to know the number she rolls. With your head still turned, have her quietly deal a quantity of cards equal to her rolled number (nine) face down onto the table. She then notes the next card on the deck and places the dealt cards back on top, burying her selection. Your key card—the Queen of Hearts—thereby ends up directly above the chosen one. And your helper has done all this for you. This is true teamwork; that is, she has done all the work, and you get the credit, the applause and maybe even a fee!

Ask your helper to give the deck a riffle shuffle: *"Just like the riverboat card cheats."* If she cannot do this, have her give the deck to someone who possesses this skill. Once the deck

Muscle Reading



has been shuffled, have someone else cut it. Allow each of several spectators to give the deck a single cut. This looks good and it doesn't interfere with your trick at all. *"But once is not enough,"* you wittily remark. *"Therefore, I would like you to shuffle the deck again."* The helper gives the deck a second riffle shuffle. At this point anyone who does not know the underlying principle must be totally convinced that the selected card is hopelessly lost.

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In the event that no one in the audience can riffle shuffle (this has never happened to me, and I live in Switzerland!), then you may shuffle the deck yourself; but do not forget to point out that the cards are much more thoroughly mixed by this kind of shuffle. This is somewhat true, since an over-hand shuffle merely cuts the deck into several packets. If you riffle shuffle the cards yourself, don't push the interlaced cards together. Instead, use an extension of a psychological subtlety used in "The Waikiki Shuffle". (There, the extension we are about to use was not practiced because the method for that trick would have been exposed.) Ribbon spread the cards in their interwoven condition and have your helper push the cards together. She will later remember that she shuffled the cards herself. (This subtlety was independently invented by Paul Curry and Juan Tamariz.)

Take back the deck, turn it face up and ribbon spread it from left to right, so that the indices are facing you. In

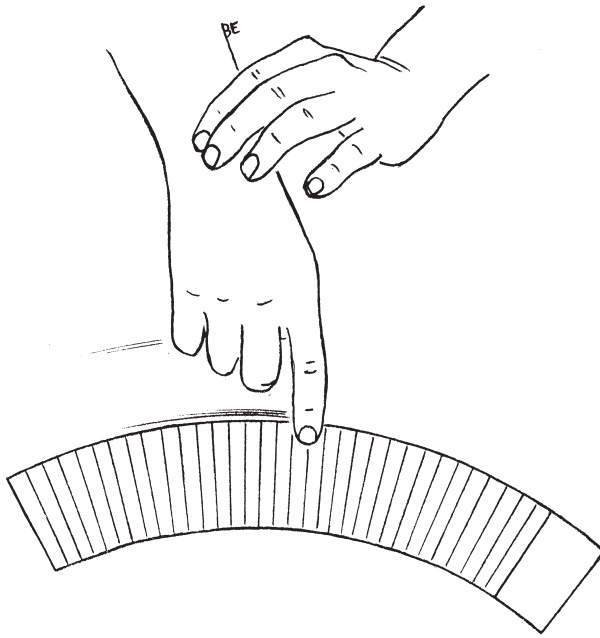
this way, you can normally spot the selection more quickly than the spectators can. While you are spreading the cards, keep an eye out for the Queen of Hearts, your key card, and find the closest heart to the *right* of the Queen. It is possible that the two cards will lie next to each other, but it is more likely that the riffle shuffle has placed some cards between them. The heart to the right of the Queen is the card your helper selected!

How is this possible? In riffle shuffling twice, the deck is divided into two “chains” that run in a cycle (and are therefore also undisturbed by cutting). Since the hearts are all bunched on top of the deck, the heart cycle is interrupted by indifferent cards, but the positions of the hearts remain unchanged in relation to each other. This ingenious principle can be used in many other tricks.⁹

53

Briefly summarize the situation once again and point out how impossible it is to discover the selected card. Turn to your helper and explain the principle of muscle reading in a few words. *“No matter how impossible it is by normal means, through the principle of muscle reading I will be able to find your card. I’d like you to merely think of it, that’s all. Thoughts activate ideomotor impulses; that is to say, unconscious muscle twitches, which can be perceived by a sensitive person.”* Gently grip your helper’s wrist and move her hand over the ribbon of cards. After moving her hand back and forth a few times, stop hesitantly above the chosen card, pause dramatically—and finally push the card out of the ribbon spread while you say with certainty, *“And that is your card, isn’t it!”* Your innocent partner, astonished and enthusiastic, will agree.

Muscle Reading



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Lest I Forget...

1. If you know something about muscle reading, and if it matches your style, you can, of course, embellish the script with pseudo-scientific explanations. It is certainly advisable in such presentations to know more than you actually say in performance. Sometimes, a person in the audience may know something about the topic, and it is never good to be at a loss when faced with a knowledgeable question. Audiences can form just as strong an opinion about the magician and his magic in moments after a performance as they do during it.
2. When I find myself with a fun-loving audience, I sometimes present the following gag immediately

after this trick. Spectators often believe I really do have the ability to read unconscious muscle movements. When they say as much, I answer, *"That isn't so difficult. You can do it yourself. Try it with me once."* I hand the deck to someone and instruct him to offer me a card. I take one at random, which I then look at, remember and show everyone but my helper. Now I return the card to the deck and do several riffle shuffles. As I am doing this, I observe that the card is shuffled back into the deck in the fairest way, just as before, and I emphasize how impossible it is for the performer to find the card. Pointing out this condition reinforces in retrospect the effect just presented. I ribbon spread the deck and ask my helper to hold my wrist and move my hand over the cards. When it is over my selection, I suddenly jerk so vigorously that I nearly fall off my chair. With the right audience, this can be very funny. Of course, as with all jokes of this type, it's important to be sensitive and to exercise good taste in judging whether and how to include it. Performed with tact, the gag is witty and humorous; without tact it is just a boisterous bar-stunt.

3. Here is yet another presentational approach, in which you seem to read the thoughts of your helper without touching the deck—at least this is how it will remain in the memories of the audience. When she has shuffled the deck and you take it for the first time, turn your head, so that you are presenting your profile to her, and say, *"Please look at me and think of*

Muscle Reading

your card. I see that you are thinking of a red card—not a black one; not a club, not a spade—it is clearly a red one—and it isn't a diamond; no, it's a heart. Yes, I'm now clearly seeing it right in front of me. I will place it here onto the table to prove what I am saying." If you play this correctly, the audience will already be convinced that you have "mentally" divined the selection, even before you look at the cards—and that is a very good effect, isn't it? Only now do you take the deck, fan it with the faces toward you, locate the Queen of Hearts and lay the heart to the right of it face down on the table. Ask your helper to name her card in a loud voice. You then reveal the card slowly, first turning its face toward yourself, then toward the audience. You can be certain this will arouse great astonishment and appreciative applause.

The Lie Detector

The theme of this trick is, as the title has betrayed, that of lie detection. Lying is something everyone has done, at least in childhood; and some people continue the practice, even into adulthood; especially those who pursue a career in politics. But we will spread the cloak of silence over this inconvenient fact; one must remain loyal to one's fellow illusionists. In any case, most people are delighted at the chance to lie to a magician, a person who is perceived by many as "lying" in the broadest (artistic!) sense. This is why the lie detector is such a popular theme in magic—and especially in card magic.

The following version of this theme offers the advantage that you do not have to learn any complicated formulas. Nevertheless, it produces an incredibly good effect.

The Lie Detector

Effect

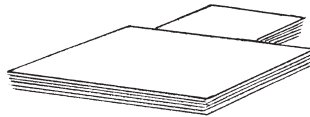
Someone notes a card and shuffles it back into the deck. She next takes seven indifferent cards, keeps them hidden and calls their names to the magician; but for one of the indifferent cards she calls the name of the card she selected. Because the magician possesses the sensitivity of a lie detector, he is able, unbelievable as it may seem, to discover the woman's card!

Staging and Handling

Have someone shuffle and cut the deck. Take it from her and ribbon spread it face up as you say, *"A deck of cards, which you have shuffled. You must admit that the cards are in a completely random order, aren't they?"* While your helper affirms this, unobtrusively note the top card of the deck, which we will assume to be the Jack of Spades. Gather the deck, square it and place it face down on the table.

58

"Please cut the deck somewhere in the middle." She cuts off about half the deck and lays it on the table. You immediately take the bottom half and lay it crosswise onto the upper half.



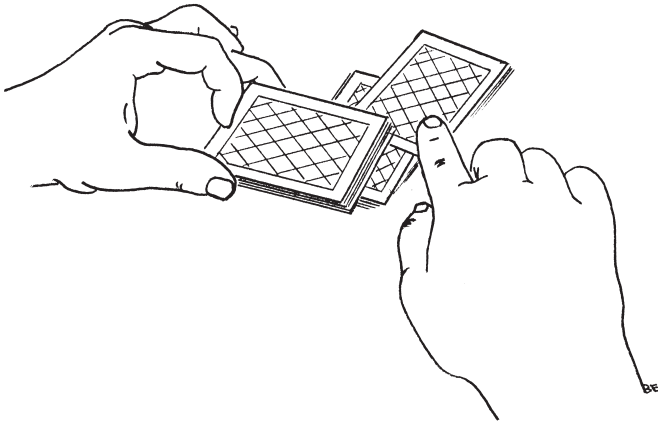
This does not need to be a precise cross, because you simply want to mark the position where your helper cut the deck. Handle the cards very casually.

"In this experiment, I want to test whether the theory of the lie detector can also be applied to the practice of card magic. You all have surely heard of a lie detector, which is able to determine when a person is lying. To do this, the test subject is asked some questions. When the questions are answered, it can be determined whether the person is lying, by means of the voice, the voltage of the skin and so on." Turn to your

CARD COLLEGE LIGHT

helper. *"If you don't mind, I would like to test it once with you. Of course, this is just a game. And in this game we need first to determine the truth. It is doubtlessly true that you have shuffled the deck, right? And that you cut it at any spot you wanted, that's also right, isn't it?"*

Lift the uppermost of the two packets and ask her to take the top card of the lower packet—that is, the Jack



59

of Spades, which you noted at the beginning of the trick. *"Good. Then please take the card at the point you cut and carefully remember it. Perhaps you can show it to some of the others, but please don't let me see it. The card is the truth about which you must later lie."*

The purpose of this rather long exposition is not just to present the idea of the presentation and to arouse interest in the audience; it also consumes a bit of time after the cutting of the deck. When your helper takes the top card of the lower packet and notes it, she will hardly remember which part of the deck was on top and which was on the bottom. In this simple but subtle way, you have compelled her to take a card that you knew in advance—or to use magicians' language, you have forced the card.¹⁰

The Lie Detector

Ask your helper to return her card anywhere in the deck; then shuffle the cards yourself. After a few seconds, give the deck back to your helper as you ask her to thoroughly shuffle it a second time. I strongly recommend this procedure of shuffling the cards first yourself, and then giving them to a spectator to shuffle, following a force. If you have the deck shuffled by your helper immediately after she replaces her card, it might create suspicion of a force, due to the total freedom allowed. If, however, you first shuffle the cards, and then, on second thought, hand them to the helper for another shuffle, it looks more casual and therefore seems innocent.

60 *"And now we come to the lie detector. Please take seven cards from the deck, and make sure your card is not one of them."* As you say this, turn away from your helper, since you do not want to see which cards she takes. When she is done, have her set the deck aside, as it is no longer needed.

"I would like you to spread the seven cards in a fan facing yourself, so that only you can see their faces. Tell me the names of the cards you are holding one at a time. But at some point, call out the name of your card. Of course, it's important that you do not allow any change in your voice or a twitch of your eyelid to give away the identity of your card. In fact, I will deliberately turn away, so that you can't reveal your card to me through body language. If you like, you may pause for a few seconds between cards, so that you don't signal your card through hesitation." As always, you should find words that match your manner of speaking and that reveal your personality. My scripts should be thought of as examples, designed to highlight the most important content. In this case, the person should be made aware that you do not use any of the methods you mention.

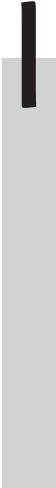
CARD COLLEGE LIGHT

It matters not at all when she names her card, since you know it already. Therefore, wait until she has named all the cards, and then look her in the eye: *"I think you lied once. You did it very well, I'll grant you, but I believe your voice gave you away. You chose the Jack of Spades!"* Name the card you forced and bring this impressive experiment to an end.

Lest I Forget...

There are, of course, many subtle techniques for learning the top card at the beginning of the trick. If you know one, by all means use it. (Some good techniques for glimpsing can be found in Chapter 23 of *Card College, Volume 2*, pages 353–9.) However, if presented casually, and in a relaxed manner, the procedure described above will certainly serve the purpose.





have constructed the routines in this book so that they can be performed with a borrowed deck. You do usually need cards of fairly good quality and condition. However, the following routine can be performed with an entirely “suboptimal” deck; that is, a deck that has survived generations or that is passed across the table at a bar or restaurant. (The term “suboptimal cards” was coined by members of the German Card Workshop and was one of the themes of the 1987 Card Workshop.)

The Circus Card Trick

The title refers to the fact that this trick was primarily used at circuses and horse-race tracks to separate unsuspecting customers from their money. It was thus originally a con game. Nowadays, it is occasionally used as a bar bet, played for a free beer. But our intention is to present it as an entertaining piece of card magic.¹¹

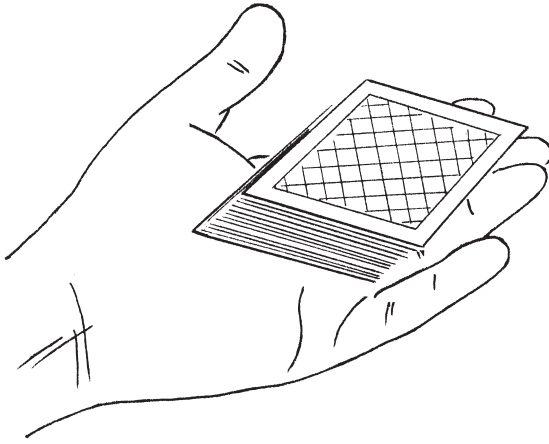
Effect

After the audience has become convinced that the performer has failed to find a selected card, he manages to save the situation in a surprising and amusing way.

Staging and Handling

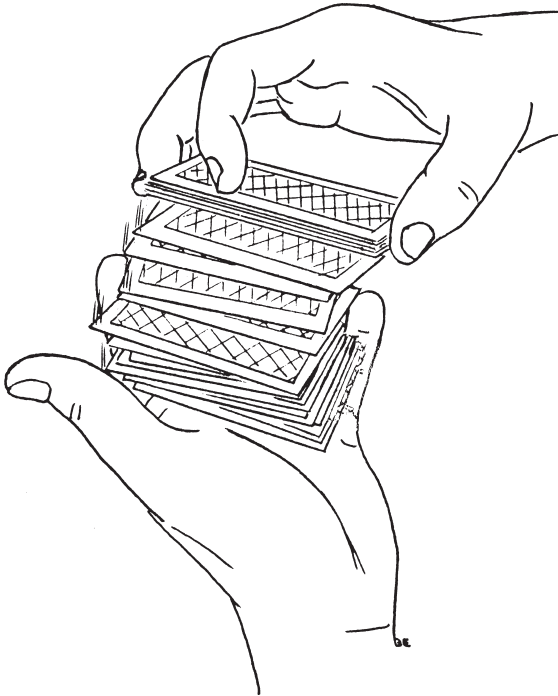
Give the deck to someone and ask him to thoroughly shuffle and cut the cards. When he has done this, take them back from him and hold the deck in your left hand in open dealing position.

The Circus Card Trick



With your right hand, grasp the deck from above by the ends (which is called “end grip”) and let small packets fall into the left hand. As you do this, ask your helper

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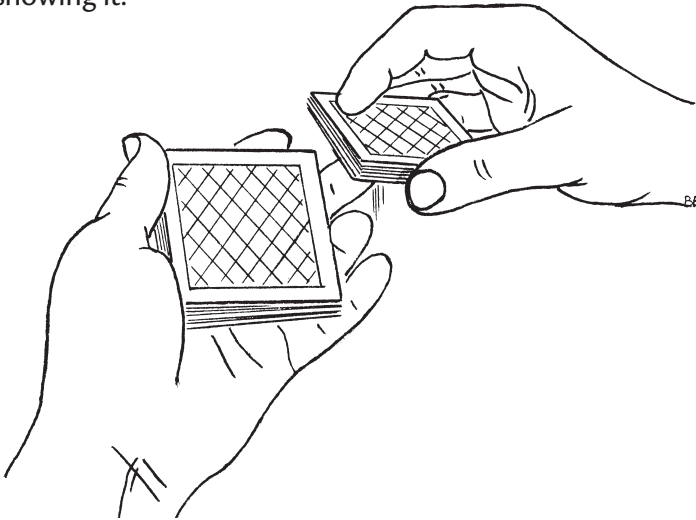
CARD COLLEGE LIGHT

to say “stop” at any time. To get him used to this selection procedure, you can demonstrate by first dribbling the whole deck into the left hand, then square up the deck and start over.

When he calls “stop”, pause. It really does not matter where he stops you, but ideally he should stop you somewhere below the midpoint.

Look at him and ask, *“Here? Good. You now have two possibilities. Would you like this card, or this card here?”* Under cover of these words, secretly note the bottom card of the right hand’s packet. Let us look a bit closer at this procedure.

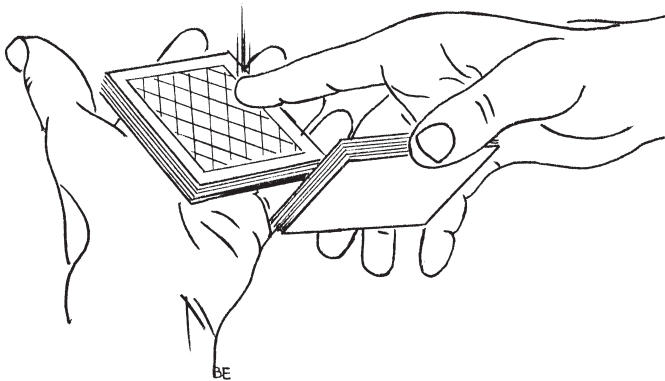
When you say, *“You now have two possibilities,”* everyone will understand that you mean either the bottom card of the right hand’s packet or the top card of the left hand’s. Pause here for two to three seconds, so that your helper can begin following this train of thought. Continue: *“Would you like this card...”* Use your left middle finger to tap the face of the bottom card of the right hand’s packet, without showing it.



The Circus Card Trick

Both packets are held horizontally and below eye level the entire time—except for the brief action of the glimpse you are about to take. During your question, the helper's attention is directed toward the right hand's packet. Again briefly pause. He will automatically continue thinking and will anticipate your next statement, since you earlier mentioned *two* possibilities. We need this pause, so that the helper's attention lingers, though not openly prompted, on the packet in your left hand. You fulfill the expectation that has been created when you tap the top card of the left hand's packet with your right forefinger: *"...or this card here?"*

70 You will have noticed that during this tapping your right hand has to move forward for a second or less. In this movement, the packet is briefly held slightly tilted and the bottom card can be glimpsed. This glimpse works best when



both packets are held somewhat farther from the body than usual. This allows you to catch a brief and subtle glance at the bottom card of the packet while it is tipped forward very slightly. Bring the right hand's packet immediately back to a horizontal position and look your helper directly in the

eyes, waiting for his answer. You have just noted your key card, which we will assume is the Queen of Clubs.

If he chooses the bottom card of the right hand's packet, show it to him, turning your head away, and then put the deck back together. You know his selection: the Queen of Clubs. And if he chooses the top card of the left hand's packet, again turn your head away and ask him to take that card, which you hold out for him. As soon as he has noted it, have him replace it on the packet. Drop the right hand's packet onto the left's as you turn your head back and look once more at the cards. You want the spectators' attention to settle on the deck at this moment, as it is being squared up in a clean and fair way. The key card is now directly above your helper's selection.

Separate the placement of the key card from the revelation of the selection by introducing a brief delay, during which you summarize the situation. *"You shuffled the deck yourself and called stop at a place of your choice. So I cannot know which card you looked at, and I also cannot know where your card is in the deck."* Almost everything you say here is true; and it is entirely true if he looked at the card on top of the left hand's packet. However, since you do know his card or the key card immediately above it, you are in control! For this explanation, we will assume the selection is the Five of Hearts and it is in the bottom half of the deck, immediately below your key, the Queen of Clubs. (I will explain later what you must do if the selection is in the top half of the deck.)

"Under these conditions it is not humanly possible to find your card. Nevertheless, I will try, with the help of my intuition!" Hold the deck face down in left-hand dealing

The Circus Card Trick

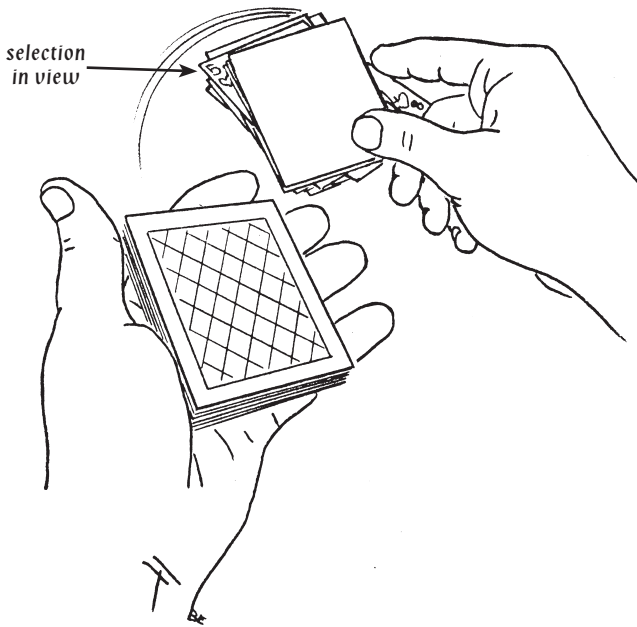
position. Begin dealing one card after another from the top of the deck face up into a pile on the table. Secretly count the cards as you deal them, because you will use the twenty-sixth card as a “sunken” key in the next trick (“The Fingerprint”). We are again applying the principle of synergy in the construction of routines, setting up in one trick elements required for the next.

72 Your dealing should be brisk, to keep this process from becoming tedious to your audience. However, to assure you do not lose your place while counting, and to create dramatic tension, I suggest pausing a moment after you have laid down the tenth card. Look at the audience, moving your gaze from left to right, and say something like “*My intuition tells me the next card I turn over—no, I don’t think that’s it yet.*” Resume dealing the cards at a spritely pace, and make another comment after the twentieth card. Continue right on, until you get to the twenty-sixth card, which you remember as your key card for the next trick. Let’s assume it is the Eight of Spades.

Without hesitating, keep turning cards over until you come to the Queen of Clubs, your key card. The next card you turn over is the Five of Hearts, which is the chosen card. Without batting an eyelash keep turning cards over, making sure that everyone can see the selection for at least a full second. It is best to deal the last few cards so that the index of the selection can still be seen.

After having dealt a few cards past the chosen one, pause again. “*My intuition tells me the next card I turn over—no, wait a minute....*” Deal two or three more cards and then finally stop with a confident expression and body language, as you assert with certainty, “*Yes, it is very clear now. My*

CARD COLLEGE LIGHT



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intuition tells me that the next card I turn over will be yours. Do you believe that is possible?" With these words, take into your right hand the card from the top of the deck, holding it in the same fashion you have held every other card you have turned over. Direct your question to the whole audience, and wait for someone to confirm that it would indeed be impossible. When someone says this, calmly place the card in your hand back onto the deck, take the Five of Hearts out of the face-up pile, and turn it face down. You have done exactly what you said you would: You've turned over the selected card! As you do this, say, "*And yet it is possible after all.*"

Make sure you mention turning over the next card several times during the dealing. This will cause the spectators to associate the wording with the action of turning over cards and eliminates any misunderstanding of your statement

The Circus Card Trick

just before the punch line. Even skeptical persons (as well as magicians who know this trick in its simple form!) will fall for your verbal subterfuge.

When, at the end, you say, *“And yet it is possible after all,”* do not look directly at the audience, but instead look at an imaginary spectator. In this way, you make no one feel foolish, since everyone present will be thinking about a single spectator who does not exist, but who “is stupid enough to fall for that trick.” (This idea, which can be used in many so-called “sucker tricks”, is a psychological stratagem created by Nate Leipzig. Dai Vernon wrote about this approach many times in his *Genii* column “The Vernon Touch”.)

74 If the selection is in the upper half of the deck, because your helper stopped you a bit later in the dribbling of the cards, simply deal cards into a pile until you have placed the twenty-seventh card (as earlier, we’ll presume it is the Eight of Spades) face up on the pile. When you take the chosen card from the face-up pile you’ve dealt, there will be exactly twenty-six cards left on the table. The uppermost card of this packet, the Eight of Spades, will be the key card for the next trick.

Lest I Forget...

1. Pay attention to the subtle linguistic deception. This basic principle can make many effects more deceptive.
2. This trick contains another very useful principle that has a wide range of application. The performer can use the trick to determine the identity and position of one or several cards in the deck. The clever thing is that this information is not used immediately, but in the next trick—or even later. This concept of using

CARD COLLEGE LIGHT

delayed information completely separates the cause from the effect and thereby protects the method in a most effective and elegant manner.

The Fingerprint

The following trick uses a sophisticated form of the very old principle of the key card. The key-card concept can be found in European magic literature as early as the sixteenth century. Here, however, the concept is used in a far subtler form, often known as a “sunken key”. This sunken key principle can be used in many ways.¹²

Effect

A freely chosen card is replaced in the deck by the spectator, under the strictest conditions. In spite of this, the magician is able to find the card by means of the “fingerprints” left on it!

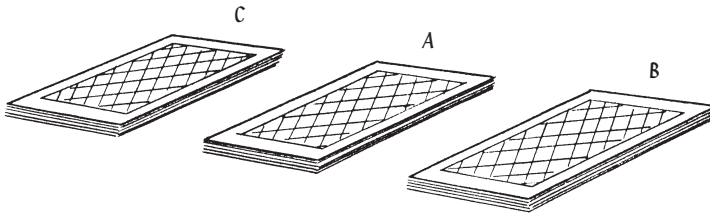
Props

In addition to a deck of cards you will need a magnifying glass, which you can carry in an easily accessible pocket. The trick can also be performed without this extra prop.

Staging and Handling

If you perform this trick immediately after “The Circus Card Trick”, you already know the twenty-sixth card from the top of the deck (we earlier elected the Eight of Spades for this position). This is your key card.

Place the deck in front of someone and ask him to cut off about two-thirds of it to his right. Then have him place about half of this cut-off top portion—about one-third of the deck—to the left of these two piles. In the drawing, shown from your helper’s view, Pile A is the bottom third, Pile B is the middle, and Pile C is the top third. Due to the nature of this cutting procedure, our key card, the Eight of Spades, is somewhere in the middle of Pile B.



Point to Pile C and remark, *“That pile was originally the top part of the deck. If I were to ask you to look at the top card, that wouldn’t be anything special, since I could already know that card. So please shuffle that pile thoroughly, until you’re convinced that no one could know the top card.”* When he has done this, ask him to look at the top card. It is best if several onlookers note the card, in case your helper forgets it later on. Next, ask him to put his card on top of the packet and place the packet back on the table.

Point to Pile A and say, *“That was originally the bottom part of the deck. I wouldn’t want you to think I could know any of those cards. So please shuffle that pile completely and lay it on top of this pile containing your card.”* When this has

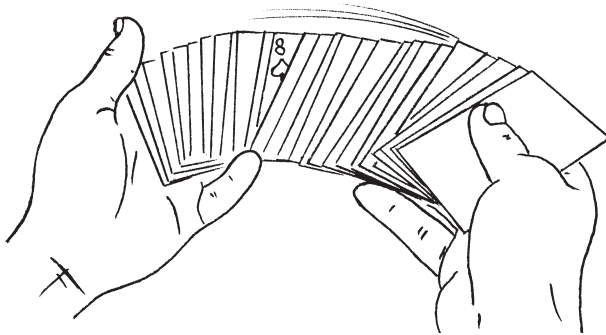
The Fingerprint

done, have your helper complete the assembly of the deck. It doesn't matter in which order the two remaining piles are placed onto each other, since a cut does not change the cyclical order of the cards.

Summarize: *"You will certainly agree that I have not touched the deck this entire time."* The rhetorical form of this question demands a positive answer, quite apart from the fact that what you are saying is true! Continue: *"You have cut the piles yourself, so no one can know which or how many cards were in each one."* Wait for your helper to confirm both assertions. *"Moreover, you also thoroughly shuffled the packets."* As you say this, mime a shuffling motion in the air to make it easier for him to remember, and nod your head.

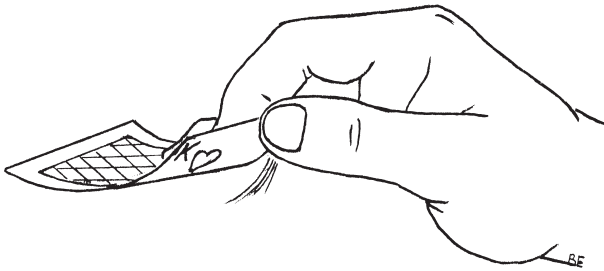
78 *"You have to admit that it would be a stroke of pure luck if I were to find your card now."* Pause. *"Nevertheless, I will find your card—using your fingerprints! Your card is the only one whose face you have touched. May I please take a look at your fingerprints?"* Look closely at your helper's right thumb, as if you were remembering the design of his thumbprint. If you have the magnifying glass with you, use it, and the moment will seem even more genuine.

Spread through the deck with the faces toward you, until you come to the key card. At the same time, keep looking at



your helper's thumb. As soon as you come to the key card, begin counting, starting with the card immediately to the left of it. The twenty-fifth card to the left of the key card is the selection. (If you count the key card itself, the selection is the twenty-sixth card. This may be easier to remember.) If you come to the end of the deck before you have counted twenty-six cards, just close up the spread and keep counting from the face of the deck until you come to the chosen card. This takes advantage of the cyclical order of the cards.

Lay that card face down on the table and ask your helper the name of his selection (say, the King of Hearts). When he names it, look at the tabled card again, briefly lifting its inner end.



Hesitate briefly, and then announce triumphantly, *"I will now enhance this trick by transforming your King of Hearts into an Ace of Spades!"* Here you first name the chosen card and then any indifferent one. Wait a few seconds for the spectators to react; then continue innocently, *"Or would you rather have your King of Hearts?"* With these words, turn the card over on the table—it is the King of Hearts!

Lest I Forget...

1. If you leave the key card and the selection face up while you practice, you will soon understand the

The Fingerprint

subtle principle on which this trick is based. The deck does not need to be complete, and you could use European decks with thirty-two or thirty-six cards. In this case you would note either the sixteenth or the eighteenth card, respectively, as a key card. The key card may be placed at any position; the only important thing is that it ends up in the pile that is cut from the middle section, when the deck is divided. The sunken-key principle is not only very clever, but also adaptable to many situations. Perhaps you can think of several applications right now?

2. If for some reason you do not want to perform “The Circus Card Trick”, you can determine the twenty-sixth card in this way: Force a card known to you, using one of the methods described in this book; for example, the crisscross force taught in “The Lie Detector” (page 58). Have your helper shuffle the deck. Then spread it with the faces toward you. Note the bottom card, which will be your key card, and spread twenty-six cards further. Cut the deck at this position, and keep spreading until you come to the selection, which you now effectively reveal in some way to the baffled spectator. In any case, your new key card is in the required position, and you can go straight into “The Fingerprint Trick”.

Magical Match

The basic principle of this trick once again dates back quite far in the history of magic. It is ingenious in its simplicity, and it is nearly impossible to figure out.¹³

Effect

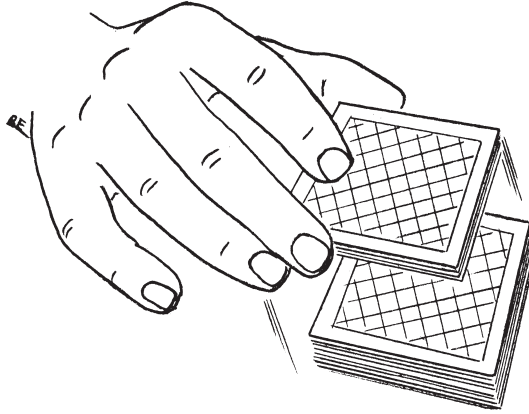
The magician twice determines, in an inexplicable manner, the exact number of cards the spectator has cut from the deck!

Staging and Handling

The deck is given to someone to mix, who then sets it face down on the table. You remark, *"You have thoroughly shuffled and cut the deck, so no one can know the order of the cards. Would you please cut a packet off the deck. In principle, you could cut off as many cards as you want, but perhaps you could take about a quarter of the deck or so; otherwise, the procedure will take too long."* With these words, you can almost always assure that your helper will cut

Magical Match

off about a quarter of the deck. As long as she doesn't cut off more than half the cards, the trick will work. In the rare event that she takes more than half the deck, simply ask her to put a few cards back.



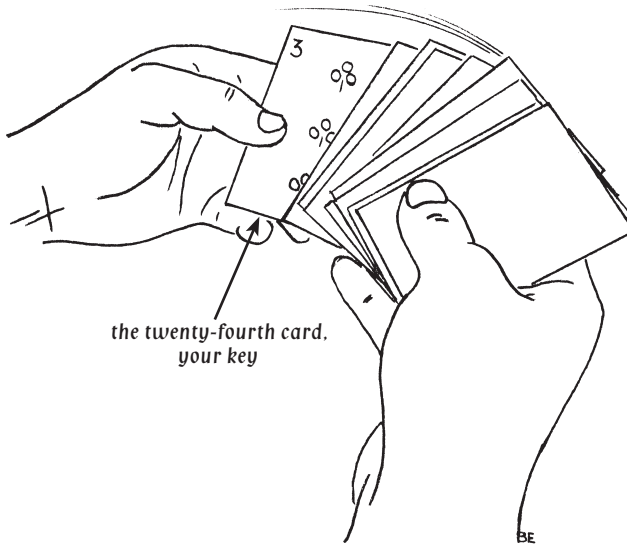
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When she has done this, you also cut off a packet, being sure to take more cards than she has. The exact number doesn't matter—all that is important is that you take *more* cards than she holds.

"I will now turn away, so that you can count your cards. Please do so quietly and to yourself, so that there is no way for me to know how many cards you have. Meanwhile, I will count my cards." Suiting actions to words, turn away, count your cards as quickly as possible, and also note the top card of your packet. This card will play a role in the second phase of the trick. It is best if you finish before your helper. Let's assume you have counted twenty-four cards and your top card is the Three of Clubs.

Turn back to your helper. *"Have you counted your cards and remembered the number? Good. I have counted mine as well. I will now make three statements. First, I have exactly*

CARD COLLEGE LIGHT



as many cards as you. Second, I have three more cards than you have; and third, I have exactly enough cards left over to add to your cards and make twenty-one." Except for the last one, these statements will be the same for every performance. You get the last number by subtracting three from the number of cards you have counted in your packet. In our example, $24 - 3 = 21$. That is all; the rest is automatic.

"Let us now count our cards onto the table at the same time." Your helper and you do this, counting the cards one at a time into face-down piles, so that everyone can hear. (By the way, this also puts your key card, the Three of Clubs, at the bottom of your pile.) Let's assume she has fifteen cards. When she has finished counting her cards into a pile, you note, "You see, first of all, I have exactly as many cards as you." Pause for one second, "Second, I have three more cards than you do." Set aside three of the cards remaining in your hand. "And third, I now have enough cards left over to add

Magical Match

to your cards and make twenty-one!" With these words you count the rest of your cards onto your helper's pile, beginning with sixteen and continuing, per your prediction, to twenty-one, which exhausts the cards you hold. If you can understand the principle in the explanation that follows, you will spare yourself all the memorization.

This trick works, very simply, because your packet contains more cards than that of your helper. The three cards are merely subtle misdirection; if you were simply to say that you had enough cards left over, when added to your helper's cards, to total twenty-four, the basic principle would be transparent. However, presented as taught above, it is very difficult to penetrate the secret; yet the effect is clear and baffling. What more could one want?

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If you wish, you can ask your helper to count her cards again, to double-check, in case she doesn't believe there really are twenty-one. In fact, I recommend this.

Meanwhile, quietly pick up the three cards you set aside earlier, place them onto your pile of fifteen and place this assembled pile onto the rest of the deck. Finally, take your helper's twenty-one cards and place them on top of all. Your key card is now thirty-ninth from the top (fifteen plus three cards from you, plus twenty-one cards from your helper, is thirty-nine—it could hardly be simpler). You have just set up the second part of the trick in a subtle and undetectable way that, you can be sure, will cause many a magician to rack his brains.

"But maybe you think that this was a coincidence. Let's repeat the experiment. Please cut off a packet of cards, this time perhaps a larger one—about half the deck or a little more." This time you do not need to estimate how many

cards your helper removes. The only important point is that she doesn't cut off more than thirty-nine. If you use the words given above, this should never happen. It goes without saying that you turn away while she cuts off the packet. Before you turn around, say, *"Place your free hand on top of your pile, so that I cannot see how many cards you have."*

Let's say that this time twenty-two cards have been cut off. Turn back to your helper and cut off enough cards from the balance to assure that your key card, the Three of Clubs, is among them. This is not hard: You must merely cut off a big enough packet and leave just a few cards on the table, since you know that your key card was at the thirty-ninth position from the top.

Just as before, both of you count your cards quietly and privately, turning away to do so. You begin by spreading your cards face up until you come to your key, the Three of Clubs. Only when you spot it do you begin to count cards, counting the key card as number one. Assume that you've counted seventeen cards, including your key. Because your key card was originally thirty-ninth from the top, if you merely subtract seventeen from thirty-nine, you will get the number of cards your helper has just cut off. In our case, thirty-nine minus seventeen is twenty-two.

Now quickly spread the first few cards and determine how many lie over the Three of Clubs. We will assume there are eight. Adding this number to the seventeen cards you have from the Three of Clubs on, gives you the total number of cards you are holding: twenty-five. If you work through this once with cards in hand, you will see that this is very simple and completely logical, upon which you will immediately understand the logic of the whole process.

Magical Match

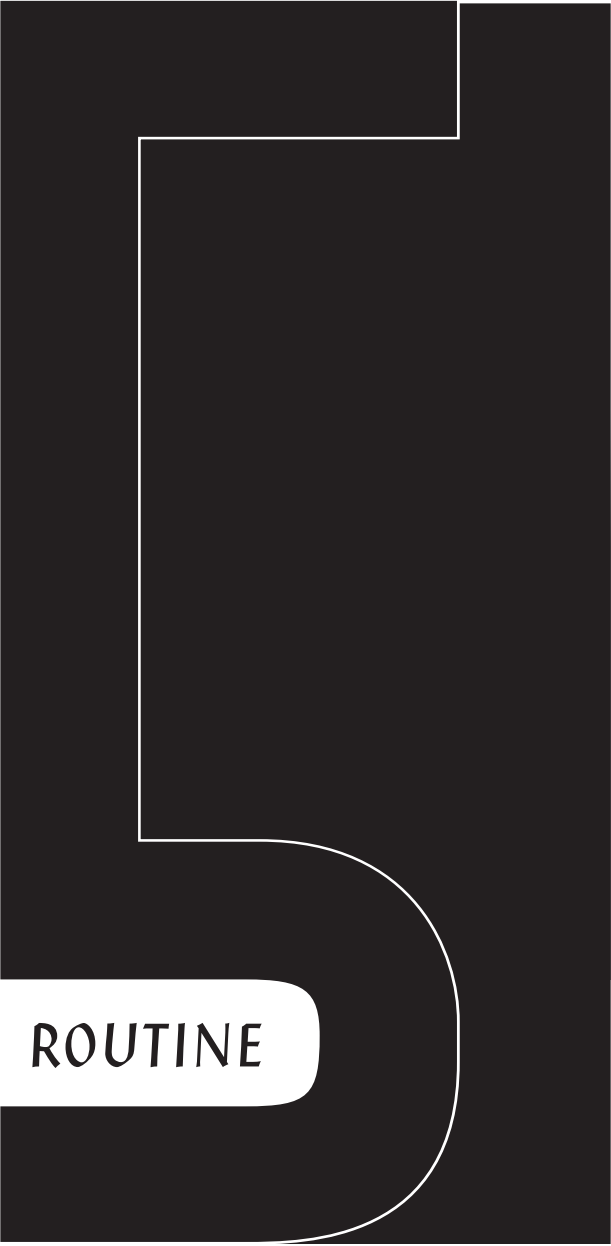
Turn back toward your helper, whom you know to be holding twenty-two cards. You are holding twenty-five. *"I have twenty-five cards,"* you say, naming the number of cards you hold. *"If I place three cards aside..."* You do so. *"...I have exactly as many cards as you do."* Once again, you and your helper each count loudly and clearly your own cards, and you both arrive at twenty-two—a truly magical match!

In this example, I have assumed that you took more cards than the helper. If you take fewer cards, you change your pronouncement (assuming you have, say, twenty cards): *"I have twenty cards. If I take two more cards..."* You take two additional cards from the remainder of the deck. *"...then I am holding exactly as many cards as you."* End the presentation as described above.

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Lest I Forget...

I have often found that even knowledgeable colleagues in magic to whom I have explained the secret have needed some time to understand the principle on which this trick is based. You should, therefore, try to get the method completely clear in your mind. Once you understand it, the trick requires practically no memory work at all.



ROUTINE



It is sometimes desirable to perform a trick that requires a more complex arrangement of cards. Stacked-deck tricks can often achieve an enormous effect with little effort. However, such tricks are all too often seen through, even by lay audiences, when the magician simply takes the deck out of its case and begins the performance without shuffling the cards.

It is much better to first perform a few tricks with a deck that can be randomly mixed, and then secretly exchange it for another deck in the course of a routine. If you then perform a trick with an arranged deck, its arrangement won't be suspected, since you are apparently using cards that were completely shuffled by members of the audience.

Tools

You need two decks of cards and a piece of cardboard that is somewhat larger than a deck. You should also be wearing a jacket for this routine.

Preparation

Perform your miracles with the visible deck. The other deck is arranged as follows: In a deck of fifty-two cards there are exactly twenty-two that have a "one-way face." These cards are:

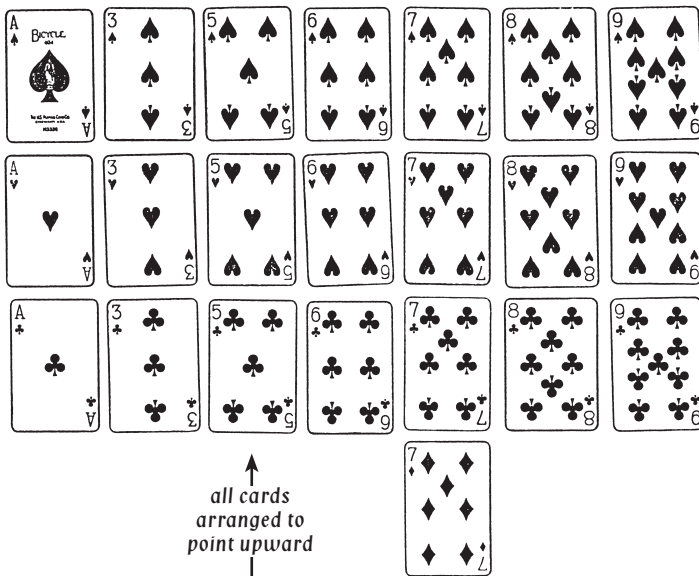
Act 5

A♥-3♥-5♥-6♥-7♥-8♥-9♥-A♠-3♠-5♠-6♠-
7♠-8♠-9♠-7♦-A♣-3♣-5♣-6♣-7♣-8♣-9♣

Take these cards from the deck and set them in a face-up pile.

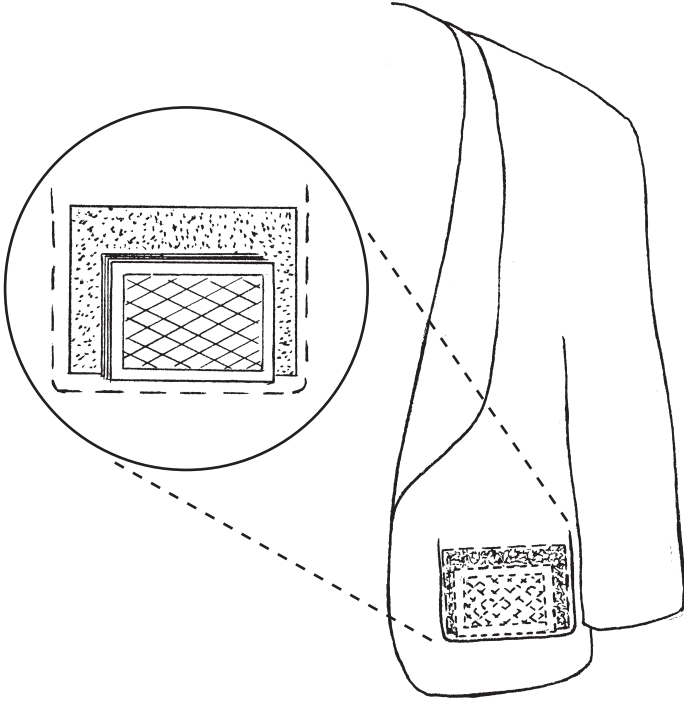
Let's first examine the principle of the one-way face. We will consider the first card, the Ace of Hearts. You will notice that this card is given a "direction" by the asymmetrical heart symbol, and that it looks different when it is turned end for end. The spade and club pips have a similar orientation; and the pip between the two columns of pips on the Seven of Diamonds is set off center. Any cards other than this Seven and the Aces have multiple pips, and the orientation follows that of the majority of the pips. We will make use of the right-side-up and upside-down attribute of these twenty-two cards. Turn them so that they all point in the same direction. It takes very little practice to be able to tell on the spur of the moment whether a card is right-side up or upside down.

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CARD COLLEGE LIGHT

Set these twenty-two cards, in random order, on top of the deck, so that even a close examination will not reveal an arrangement.



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Now place any other card, say the Four of Hearts, on top of the one-way group and put the deck into your left-side jacket-pocket, the face of the deck turned toward you. Place the piece of cardboard next to the deck on the side nearest your body. This provides a separator that assures that you do not later confuse this deck for the second one.

Cards Never Lie!

Lay audiences find the first trick of this routine exceedingly effective. It was taught to me by my friend in Strasbourg, France, Richard Vollmer. Richard tells me he encountered the basic idea in a trick by the American bar-magician, J. C. Wagner.¹⁴

Effect

Someone selects a card and shuffles it back into the deck. The magician asks three questions about the card, and his subject either lies or tells the truth. Nevertheless, the performer is able not only to ascertain the chosen card, but he also immediately produces the other three cards of the same value!

Preparation

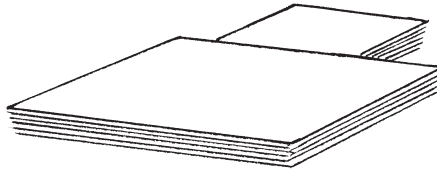
The top seven cards in the deck are arranged as follows: Jack of Hearts, Jack of Spades, Jack of Diamonds, King of Diamonds, Ten of Hearts, Ace of Diamonds, Jack of Clubs. The Jack of Hearts is the top card,

Cards Never Lie!

while the Jack of Clubs is seventh from the top. After you have gone through the trick once with the cards, you will understand the significance of the individual cards and, with very little to remember, will be able to get them into the correct order.

Staging and Handling

You first must force the top card, the Jack of Hearts, without changing the order of the other six cards of your stack. I recommend the crisscross force, described in “The Lie Detector” (page 58). Briefly: Have the deck cut by someone and set the bottom portion of the deck crosswise on the top portion.



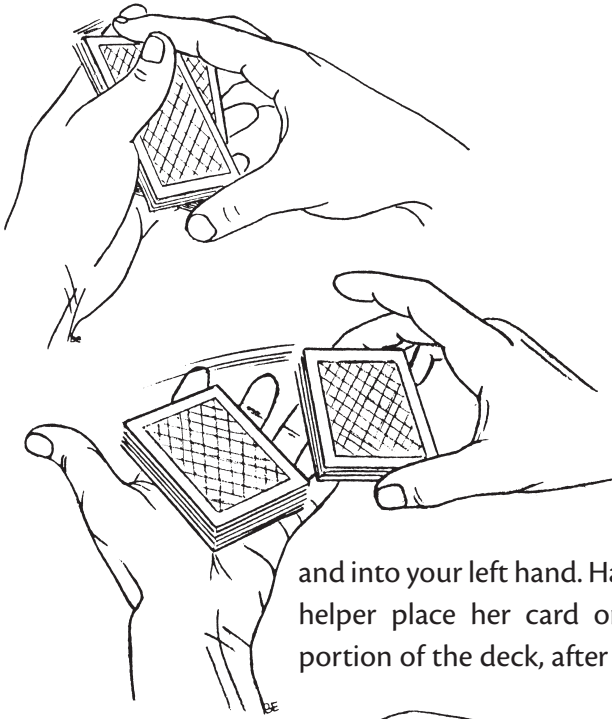
94

For the time delay necessary for this force to be convincing, you could use the following as a prologue: *“This is my most modern trick, because it uses the principles of artificial intelligence to find a card. I am referring to a so-called computer-controlled lie-detector program. But first, we need a card. Please take the card you cut to.”* With these words, indicate to your unsuspecting subject the top card of the lower packet of the deck (the Jack of Hearts). Have her remember the card and show it to the group while you turn away.

Lay the bottom portion of the deck onto the top portion and square the cards. This returns the six remaining cards of your stack to the top of the deck. With your palm-down right hand, grip the deck from above, taking it into end grip, and with your right index finger lift and swivel

CARD COLLEGE LIGHT

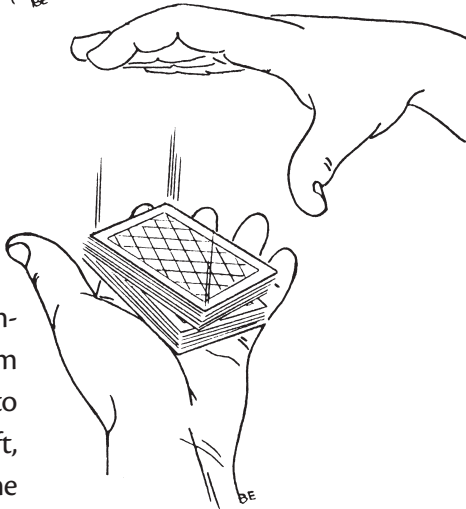
approximately half the deck to the left...



and into your left hand. Have your helper place her card onto this portion of the deck, after which...

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you drop the remainder of the deck from your right hand onto the cards in the left, hopelessly losing the selection.



Cards Never Lie!

To emphasize this condition, you can spread the face-down deck in a ribbon across the table. In reality the Jack of Hearts has been simply placed on top of the other six cards of your stock.

"The lie-detector program runs on a new seven-bit system, which means I need exactly seven cards to start the program running." Of course, this is all fiction, but those who know nothing about computers won't be able to question your statements; and those having more knowledge will either be amused or may actually believe there is a new operating system.

96 Fan the cards with the faces toward you and cut the Jack of Hearts to the rear. Turn the deck face down and place the top seven cards (your setup) onto the table *without reversing their order*. Then set the deck aside, as it will not be used for the duration of the trick.

Turn to the person who took the card. *"I will now ask you some questions directly related to your card. You can answer these questions truthfully—but you can also lie. You will see that it makes absolutely no difference whether you lie or tell the truth, since the lie-detector program will find the truth no matter what you say."*

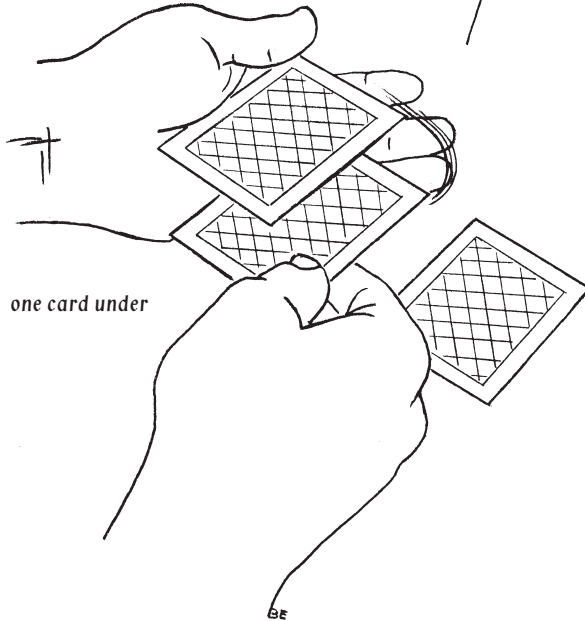
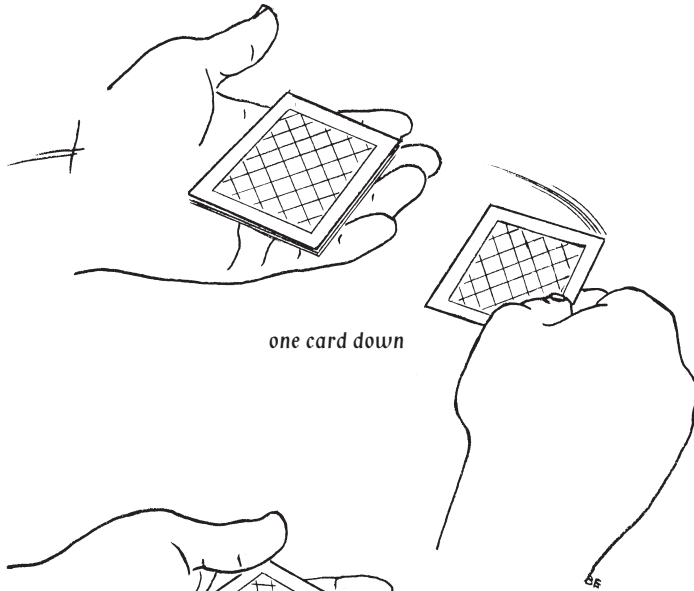
This challenge offers strong emotional intrigue, which guarantees that you will have and maintain everyone's attention from the very beginning. It is the sum of moments such as this that form the backbone of dramatic presentation.

After this declaration, you ask the first of four questions. *"Was your card a red card or a black one?"*

When your helper has answered, pick up the packet of seven cards and hold it face down in left-hand dealing position. Deal the top card face down onto the table.

CARD COLLEGE LIGHT

Place the next card under the remaining five in your left hand; then deal the next card onto the card on the table, the next one under the remaining cards, and so on, until you are down to a single card in your hand.



Cards Never Lie!

Turn this remaining card face up—it is the Ace of Diamonds. *“Aha, a red card, which proves you lied, since you took a red card.”* If your helper told the truth, you should of course change your statement accordingly.

This is admittedly a rather unusual dealing procedure (known to magicians as a “down-under deal”), and is justified by saying, *“Just like every modern computer, this one is encoded in the binary system.”*

Now ask the second question: *“Since it was a red card, it must be either a heart or a diamond. Was it a heart or a diamond?”* After the person answers, repeat the “binary calculation procedure” described above, dealing the first card to the table, slipping the next one under the packet and so on, until one card remains. Turn this card face up—the Ten of Hearts. *“The Ten of Hearts tells me your card must have been a heart.”* True.

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Ask, *“Was your card a spot card or a picture card?”* Perform another down-under deal, until one card is left, the King of Diamonds. *“This proves your card was a picture card.”* Up to this point, the step-by-step revelation of the chosen card will astonish your audience since, after all, they believe you are using seven cards taken randomly from the deck. You will now see why it is important that all the spectators see the card when it is chosen: The more people who know the selection, the greater the reaction will be each time you turn the remaining card over.

You now change the procedure slightly. *“Now please tell me, for the first time, the truth, the whole truth and nothing but the truth, so help you your memory: What was your chosen card?”* Your helper will have to answer, *“The Jack of Hearts.”*

CARD COLLEGE LIGHT

Repeat the down-under dealing process described above. This will leave you holding the Jack of Hearts—and on the table are the other three Jacks. First, slowly turn over the Jack of Hearts—*first* climax. Then declare, “*You know, cards never lie!*” Now turn up the other three Jacks—*second* climax!

Lest I Forget...

The accomplished sleight-of-hand magician will wish to use the classic force to force the Jack of Hearts, or if he wishes to play it safe, the riffle force. (Both these forces are described in detail in *Card College, Volume 1*, pages 215–26.) The forced selection can then be brought to the top of the deck using advanced methods, without looking through the cards, after which the deck can be given a false shuffle. This makes the discovery of the chosen Jack, and the production of the other three Jacks, even more astonishing.

Digital Dexterity

In the course of this trick, the deck in use will be exchanged for the prepared deck in your pocket. The concepts that inspired this trick are a Card at Any Number method that dates back to at least the early 1850s and an idea of the American master Al Baker.¹⁵

Effect

A chosen card is shuffled back into the deck by the person who selected it, and the deck is placed into the magician's pocket. With seemingly unbelievable dexterity, he is able to fish the chosen card out of the deck!

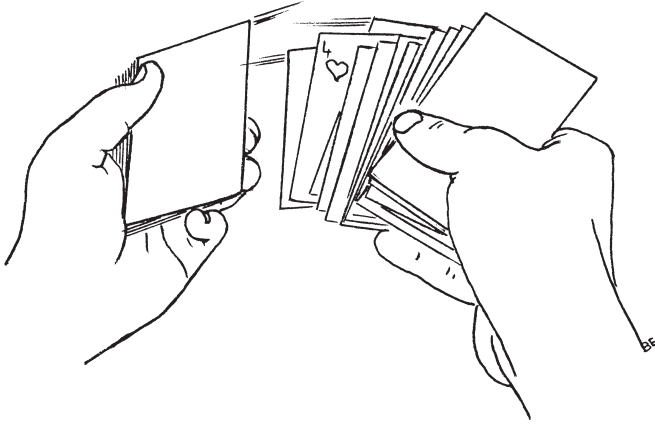
Staging and Handling

Give the deck to someone for shuffling and cutting.

Take the deck back and spread it face up, from left hand to right, as you remark, *"If I were to ask you to take a card like this, you certainly could let yourself be influenced by one card or another that appealed to you more."* While making this statement, you have spotted

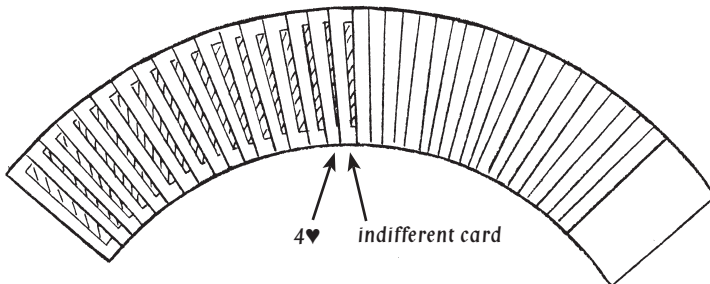
CARD COLLEGE LIGHT

the Four of Hearts in the spread. Separate the deck one card to the left of the Four and place the left hand's portion of the deck onto the right hand's portion, bringing the Four of Hearts second from the rear of the deck.



"To assure your choice is a random one, I would like you to cut the deck like this." Turn the deck face down and place it on the table. Lift off about a third of the cards, turn them face up and return this packet to the face-down deck. Now grasp the deck a bit lower and lift about two-thirds of it. Turn this packet over and set it on the remaining third. *"After cutting the deck in this way, at two random places, look at the first face-down card."* Demonstrate this by ribbon spreading the deck. *"In this case it would be the..."* Turn up and name the first face-down card.

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Digital Dexterity

"Of course, it will be a different card every time." While you say this, drop the displayed card you are holding onto the face of the ribbon spread, turn all the face-up cards face down, and use them to scoop up the rest of the deck. This brings the Four of Hearts to the top.

Now hand the face-down deck to the person you've been explaining all this to, so that he can choose and look at a card in the way you've just demonstrated. He will note the Four of Hearts, the card known to you long ago. (This method of forcing was invented by the American magician Ed Balducci. The psychological subtlety of producing a different card during the initial demonstration was added by the astonishingly prolific American card-expert, Edward Marlo.¹⁶) Once your helper has looked at the card, have him return it anywhere in the face-down portion of the spread deck, right the face-up cards, so that all are face down, and give the deck several cuts.

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Take the deck back from him and give it a brief shuffle. *"I will now try to find the card you selected, using pure dexterity. You know what? Why don't you shuffle the deck again—really mix it—so that I really can't know where your card is?"* With these words, directed to a second person, hand the deck to her for shuffling.

"To make the trick more difficult, I will perform it in the dark and without looking—using only the advanced sensitivity of my fingertips!" With these words, take the deck, look for a good place and finally put it into your left-side jacket-pocket, positioning it on the side of the piece of cardboard nearest your body. Your stacked deck, with the Four of Hearts on top, lies on the other side of the cardboard partition, safely separated from the shuffled deck.

After an appropriate dramatic buildup, reach into your pocket and take out the top card of the stacked deck. Without showing its face, place this card face down on the table. Now ask the person who chose the card to name his selection. Then turn the card face up on the table. It is his!

While the audience is applauding, reach into your pocket and calmly take out the prepared deck. The cardboard will make this considerably easier. In the course of a truly baffling trick you have imperceptibly exchanged one deck of cards for another—practically under the audience's noses.

Lest I Forget...

1. If you prefer, the deck can be exchanged in one of your inside breast pockets. The presentation remains essentially the same. You will perhaps be a bit safer doing it this way, if you have aggressive spectators who insist on reaching into your pockets to see what might be there. If you use an inside breast pocket, which is almost an "intimate area" of your body, such behavior is less likely.
2. When the arrangement of the cards is inconspicuous, as it is here, at the end of the trick you can spread the cards face up on the table and say, *"And of course there is no other Four of Hearts in the deck!"* This should satisfy even the skeptics.

Think Stop!

The handling of this trick, which is based on a very old principle of card magic, can be traced back to the efforts of the respected American professional Bruce Cervon, a student of the great Dai Vernon.¹⁷ This is an intelligent, yet very easy handling of a classic method for locating a selection. In this form, even magicians are puzzled by the trick, something I can confirm, based on countless performances!

Effect

Someone freely selects a card, then shuffles it back into the deck. Nevertheless, the magician is able to find the card through that person's silent thought-command alone.

Staging and Handling

Spread the deck between your hands and ask someone to take a card. For the trick to succeed, your recruit must choose one of the top twenty-two.

This goal should be achieved without fail if you spread the cards relatively slowly and assume a relaxed attitude.

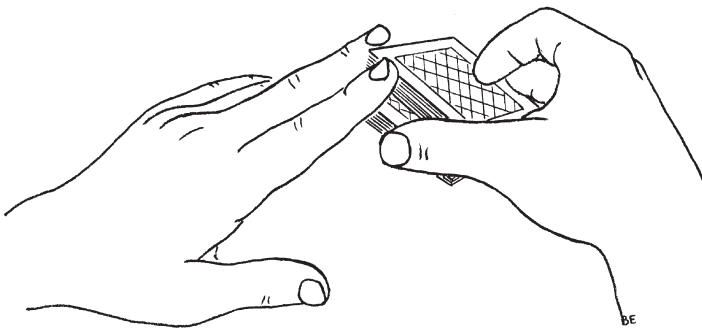
When a card has been taken, have your helper remember it and, just to be safe, have her show it to others nearby.

Respread the deck between your hands to have her return her card, but this time spread the cards a bit more quickly as you ask her to put her card back. In this way, you will have already spread through half of the deck before she can move to comply, assuring that her card is replaced in the bottom portion. Square the deck at your fingertips and drop it into left-hand dealing position. Thus, the card has been selected in a clearly fair manner, and is put back into the deck in a fashion just as fair and clear.

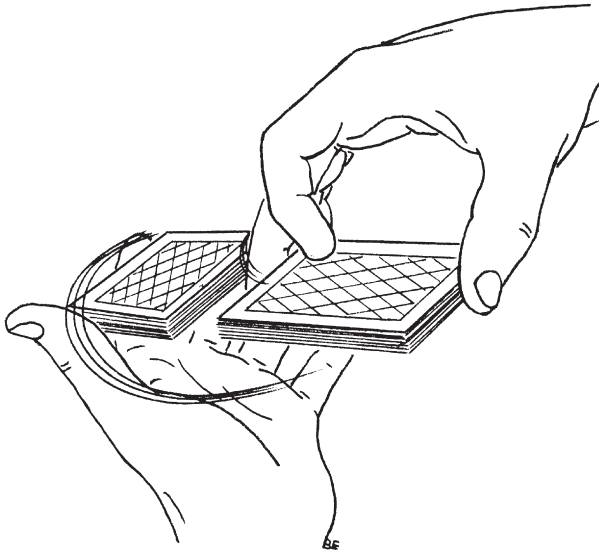
Even people who know the principle of the “one-way back” or “one-way face” will wait in vain for you to turn the deck around, while your helper notes her card. The secret reversal of the deck does not happen until after any suspicion of it has evaporated!

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To accomplish this reversal, the deck is given a swivel cut as follows: Take the deck into right-hand end grip, and with your right thumb form a break at the near end, around center. This is the simplest and surest way to pick up at least twenty-one cards. Place your left index finger at the near left corner of



Think Stop!



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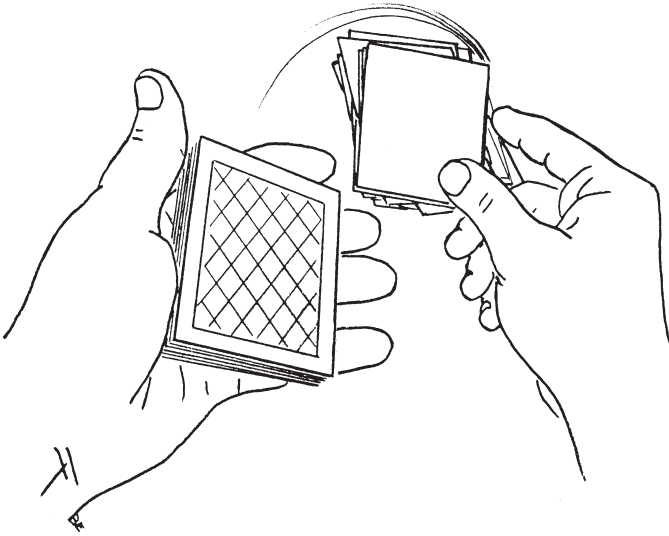
the upper packet and pivot this packet forward 180 degrees. The first phalanx of your right middle finger serves as a pivot post. Let the cut-off packet fall into left-hand dealing position and drop the right hand's packet on top.

Cutting in this fashion causes the chosen card, which was originally in the bottom half of the deck, to be the only card of all the one-way cards that points in the opposite direction. And you did everything with a casual, easy cut, which looks elegant as well.

The cards can now be mixed with an overhand or a riffle shuffle that does not turn cards end for end in the process. Nevertheless, you are capable of finding the selection at any time. As I mentioned in "The Lie Detector" (page 60), I suggest that you first give the deck a quick shuffle after the cut, and only then hand it to your helper for mixing.

When she has done this, retrieve the deck, hold it face down in left-hand dealing position and begin dealing cards

CARD COLLEGE LIGHT



into a face-up pile. Ask your helper to say nothing, but to *think* “stop” when she sees her card. To eliminate any possibility of your determining the card from a change in her facial expression (you claim), you will not look at her, but will keep your gaze fixed on the cards. She, on the other hand, should look at your profile and observe the cards. *“This way, I will be able to hear when you think ‘stop.’”* This presentation was frequently used by American past-master Jimmy Grippo, and it is very effective.

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You now simply deal until you come to the first of your one-way cards. You will immediately see the direction the card is pointing. Keep dealing until a one-way card turns up that points in the opposite direction. Take the next card, but suddenly pause before turning it over. Put the card back onto the deck and look at your helper. *“I believe you have thought ‘stop’—at this card, the Seven of Diamonds!”* With these words name the selection, remove it from the dealt pile and set it in front of your helper!

Think Stop!

Lest I Forget...

As with any trick beginning with an arranged group of cards on top of the deck, you can false shuffle and false cut the cards as much as you like, as long as the top twenty-two remain undisturbed on top.

ROUTINE

Card Caper

This trick relies on an ancient principle, one that has become rather well-known even to the public: the divided stack. However, instead of arranging the deck into red and black banks, the use of even- and odd-valued cards, as well as the handling and presentation, transform an “old chestnut” into a trick that will deceive even expert magicians.

Effect

Two spectators each select a card from a deck that they shuffle themselves. They further shuffle their cards back into the deck. Nevertheless, the magician is able to find both spectators’ cards in an astonishing manner.

Preparation

Separate the cards into odd and even values. When doing this, think of Jacks as eleven, Queens as twelve and Kings as thirteen. One packet will thus contain

Card Caper

the following values: Ace, Three, Five, Seven, Nine, Jack and King. The second packet contains these values: Two, Four, Six, Eight, Ten, Queen. Notice that the first packet contains four more cards than the second; this will go unnoticed, as the difference in the two portions is insignificant.

Shuffle each of the two groups, so that the various values are randomly distributed. Then memorize the card on the face of the packet consisting of odd values. We will assume it is the Ace of Hearts. This is your key card. Place this packet on top of the packet of even valued cards. After preparing the deck this way, place it into its case.

Staging and Handling

112 Remove the deck from its case and ribbon spread it face up. Without your mentioning it, the spectators can see that it is a shuffled deck of fifty-two cards. *"For this trick I need the help of two volunteers. Would you, sir, and you, miss, assist me?"* As you say this, point to two persons sitting near you. *"I would like each of you to take any card from this deck."* Gather the spread cards and hold them face down in left-hand dealing position. *"But I'd like you first to shuffle the deck yourselves. Each of you shuffle part of it; it will go faster that way. We call this a 'job sharing shuffle!'"* As you are delivering these lines, turn the deck again face up and spread it in your hands until you come to your key card. Separate the deck here, giving one helper all the odd-valued cards and the other all the even-valued ones.

Notice how you have humorously justified the division of the deck between your two helpers. Do not invest any particular importance in the separation of the deck; it's best if you look at the spectators as you speak to them. With a little practice, you will easily be able to recognize your key

card from the corner of your eye. In point 2 in the Lest I Forget section below, you will find two additional suggestions for making this separation.

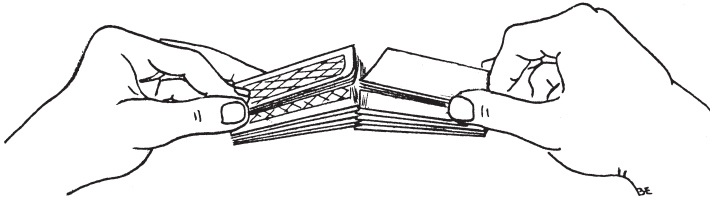
Have your helpers thoroughly shuffle their packets—first behind their backs, then over their heads, and finally with eyes closed. This humorous interlude guarantees that everyone later remembers the process of this thorough shuffling. During this unusual procedure, a few cards may even be dropped, making it even more memorable. The more grotesque their shuffling becomes, the more firmly it will remain fixed in everyone's minds. In addition to the apparatus of perception and our strategies of thinking, gaps in human memory are responsible for our ability to deceive audiences with tricks based on simple principles. We should pay just as much attention to the manipulation of the mind as to the manipulation of the cards, as sleight-of-mind and sleight-of-hand are tools of equal importance.

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Now ask each of your two helpers to remove any card from those they hold, to look at and remember it, and to show it to others nearby. This precaution, as has been mentioned before, ensures against a helper forgetting which card was taken. Make a point to turn your head away as the noting and displaying is being done. Then ask your helpers to insert their cards upside down into their own packet; that is, the selection goes face up into the face-down packet. The helpers now thoroughly shuffle their packets again. Only now, after the cards have been shuffled and squared, should you turn once more to face your two assistants.

Take the first packet and set it *face down* in front of you, in position for a tabled riffle shuffle. Place the other packet to the right of the first, but *face up*, and riffle shuffle the two

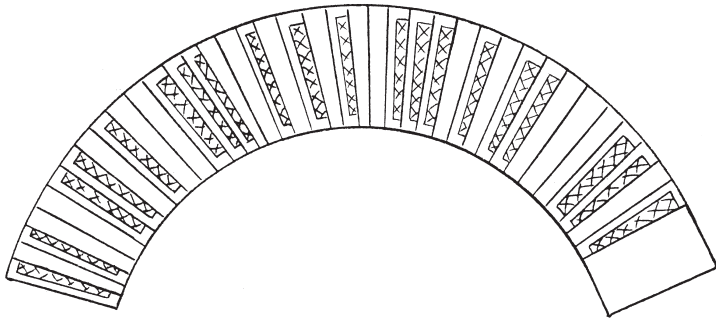
Card Caper



into each other. It is important that you once more turn your head away, *"so I can't accidentally see the reversed card."* If you know that a member of the audience is able to riffle shuffle, ask him to do the honors; in which case you don't have to touch the deck at all. Have the deck shuffled again by someone sitting nearby. He can use an overhand or a riffle shuffle.

Take back the deck and ribbon spread it. If you now examine all the face-up cards, you will see that they all have

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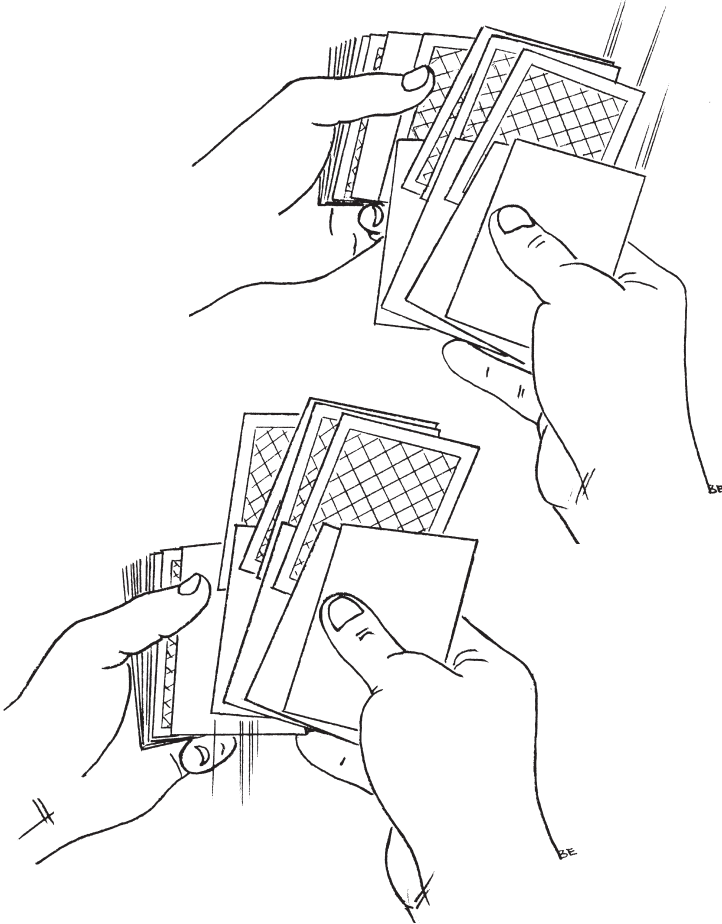
even values—all but one—and that one is the first selection. Depending on which side of the deck is up, the reverse could be the case: Among all the odd-valued cards is a single even-valued one.

To excuse your rather intense inspection of the spread, explain, *"It is, of course, quite easy to find your card. It is the only card you have touched several times, so it has your fingerprints on it!"* You can enjoy a little byplay here by looking at your helper's fingerprints and then taking his card out and setting it in front of him. That is the first card.

CARD COLLEGE LIGHT

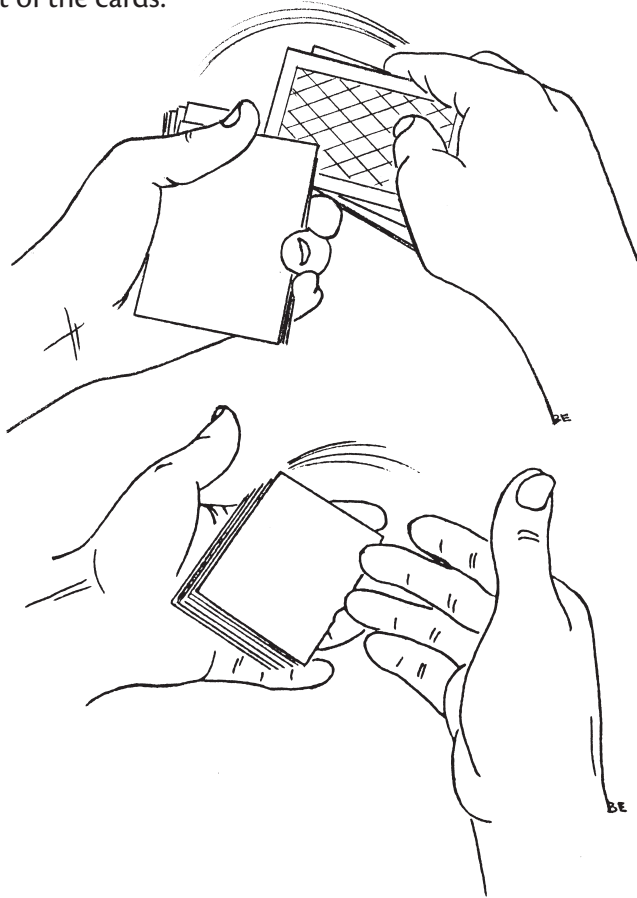
Gather up the spread, turn the deck over and ribbon spread it again. Once more look for “fingerprints on the cards”, this time belonging to the second helper. After some hesitation, slip a card from the spread and place it in front of her. It is, indeed, her card!

While the spectators are recovering from this astonishing feat, you have enough time to right the reversed cards. The best way to do this is to spread the deck in your hands and push each face-down card about halfway out of the spread.



Card Caper

When you have finished doing this, you can pull the face-down cards from the deck and flip them face up onto the rest of the cards.



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Lest I Forget...

1. To understand this rather subtle principle better, separate the deck into red and black cards. Then go through the individual steps of the trick with this color-segregated deck. The method will become immediately clear to you.

2. This trick is even more effective if, before beginning it, you mark your key card by holding it face down and bending one of its corners downward a bit. This is called a “crimp”. You can separate the deck at this crimped key without having to look at the faces of the cards. With a light touch and a bit of practice, you can cut at the crimp quite elegantly. Here is another good approach: Ribbon spread the deck face up in the beginning and, as your left hand begins to gather the spread, place your left thumb on the Ace of Hearts. As you finish gathering the cards, you can form a break above the Ace of Hearts while you square the deck. Retain this break as you turn the deck face down and take it into dealing position. After a brief delay, cut at the break and hand the top portion of the deck to one helper, the bottom portion going to the other.

In the Hands

This trick has an incredibly strong effect on a lay audience, because everything happens in the helper's hands without the magician ever touching the deck.

The following was inspired by a trick that appeared in one of Frank Garcia's famous books.¹⁸ Its origin seems unknown. My handling is completely different from the original, and its execution much surer.

Effect

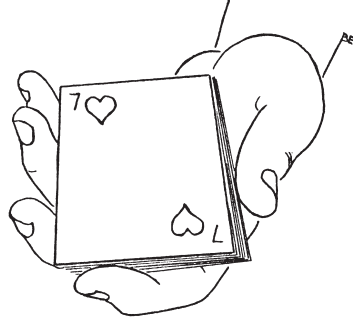
Someone from the audience shuffles a deck of cards and remembers two of them, which he himself loses back into the deck. In spite of these impossible conditions, the magician is able to locate both noted cards.

Staging and Handling

Give the deck to someone with the request that he thoroughly shuffle and cut it. *"When you are convinced the deck is well mixed, please cut off about half the cards and place them face up onto the face-down*

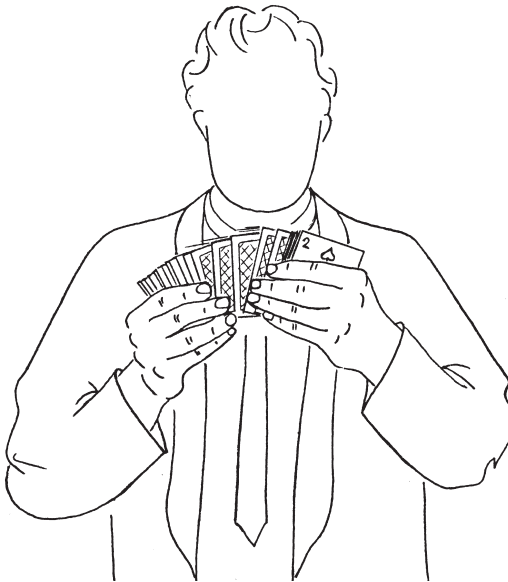
CARD COLLEGE LIGHT

half." If your helper follows your instructions correctly, he will be holding a deck that consists of about twenty-six face-up cards followed by the remainder face down. Note the card visible on top of the deck. This is your first key card; in our example it will be the Seven of Hearts.



Ask your helper to spread the deck between his hands and to look at and remember the last face-up card. To do this he should bring the deck to a more or less vertical position, since he doesn't want you to see his card. This precaution will, however, allow you to see and secretly memorize the card on the bottom of the deck; let's say it is the Two of Spades. This is your second key card. As soon as you have noted this card, turn your back to your helper.

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In the Hands

You now have all the information you need to successfully perform the trick—and before the effect has even begun! You are two steps ahead of your helper, a principle that later makes it very difficult for your audience to reconstruct the secret.

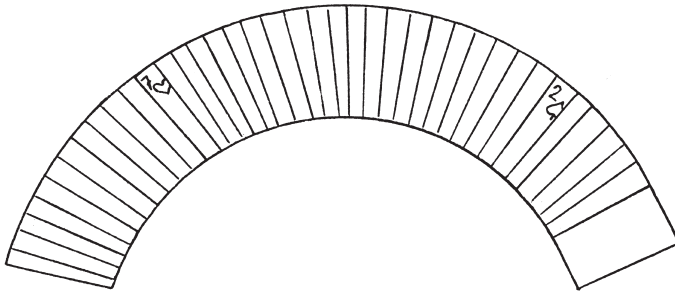
When your helper has noted this first card, have him square the cards and turn over the whole deck. Ask him to spread through the upper cards, newly turned face up, and again to note the last face-up card. You then tell him to turn the face-up cards face down onto the rest of the deck, so that all the cards face the same way. It doesn't matter here which portion he places on the other—nothing can go wrong. Your subject has just placed your second key card onto the first card he saw.

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"Now please cut the deck once more and complete the cut." Wait until he has done this. Then ask him to cut the deck yet again. In this way, your first key card is placed onto his second selection.

It is important not to tell your helper that he can cut the deck several times, as some people will then cut several small packets onto the table, and you run the risk of your key cards being separated from the selections.

All you need to do now is to take the deck, ribbon spread it and find both cards with "hyper-hydraulic permo-



dynamic powers,” as the late, great Rolf Andra used to put it. Each of the two chosen cards lies to the right of your two key cards. You might, here, introduce a pendulum and find the cards after asking your helper his zodiac sign.

Lest I Forget...

1. If you follow the described presentation faithfully, you should achieve the impression that you turn your head away at the very start, and thus could not possibly have received any hint whatsoever regarding the chosen cards.
2. When I present this trick, I always *casually* ask the person to shuffle the deck briefly. If you choose someone who is standing or is not sitting close to the table, he will almost invariably do an overhand shuffle. In this circumstance, it is very unlikely that the key card will be separated from the selection. The extra effect you gain by doing this far outweighs the small risk you run (especially with magicians)! You can, instead, false shuffle the deck yourself, which is safer and almost as convincing.

Back to the Future

This trick is the creation of Chicago magician Al Leech.¹⁹ You will be hard pressed to find a simpler one in this book. It has the advantage that it can be performed with a borrowed, shuffled deck at any time and under all conditions.

After the previous two location exercises, this concluding prediction effect offers a welcome change. I independently came up with the idea of presenting a prediction in the following form, as a time conundrum.

Effect

The magician transports himself into the future, memorizes what happens there, returns to the past, and then predicts the occurrence in the present: a confusing story with a clear effect.

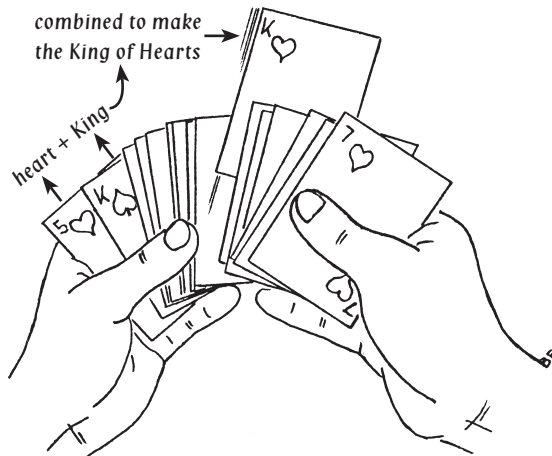
Staging and Handling

Someone is asked to shuffle the deck, cut it and place it face down on the table. Meanwhile, the magician

says, "When we talk about a prediction, most people mean an extrasensory gift or power. But that isn't quite correct, because in reality it is purely a question of time. What I mean is, I only need to transport myself into the future, see what happens there, and then return to the past in order to say something about the future in the present. So I will now take a very short trip...."

Briefly close your eyes and open them again a few seconds later, while stating, "The fact that I am once again here proves that everything is working, doesn't it? All right, then. You have been shuffling the deck all this time, and thus you have gotten it into an order that is mathematically completely random and that no one could know. From that thoroughly shuffled deck I will remove a card I have already seen in the future." Suiting your actions to words, fan the deck with faces toward you and note the top two cards. These cards must have different values and suits. If this is not the case, simply cut the deck at two appropriate cards. Let's assume the two cards are the Five of Hearts and the King of Spades. Remember the suit of the first card (heart) and the value of the second (King). From this you get a "combined" card,

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Back to the Future

the King of Hearts. This combinational card could also be the Five of Spades, if you were to use the value of the first card and the suit of the second. We'll stick with the King of Hearts for this explanation. Find this card in the deck and place it face down on the table as your prediction; or put it into the card case (which provides an even more dramatic effect). As you do this, say, *"Please be very careful that no one touches this card too soon and thus confuses the future."*

124 Reassemble the deck and square it, keeping the two known cards on top. Then hand it to someone and ask him to hold it face down. *"Please place the first card face down on the table, the second one onto that one, and so on."* He begins to deal one card after another face down into a pile on the table. As soon as he has dealt three or four cards, continue, as if it had always been your intention to say this, but you just hadn't managed yet, *"You can, of course, deal the cards from the bottom or even from the middle; it makes absolutely no difference."* When your helper has dealt another two or three cards, add, *"And please shuffle the deck a few times as you do this."*

Wait until he has dealt a few cards from every position in the deck, and shuffled it several times. When he has dealt about a dozen cards or more in this fashion, give him another set of instructions: *"You may stop at any time—whenever you wish—it doesn't matter where you stop."* The earlier he stops, the shorter the next phase will be.

"Good. Now we need two packets of about the same size. Please set the deck aside and pick up the cards on the table. Deal one card here, the second one there, the next one here on the first one, the next one there on the second one, and so on until the cards are dealt out into two piles that are about

equal." As you say this, point to two spots on the table where your helper is to deal the cards, one at a time, into two piles. If he does everything correctly—and, of course, you are very concerned that he does this!—the two cards you previously noted are now on top of the two piles. It doesn't matter if he makes one or several mistakes during the dealing—this is actually desirable, to misdirect from the mathematical nature of the action—as long as each of the two piles receives one of the last two cards.

Summarize: *"Since you yourself shuffled the cards when we began, you took the cards from different places in the deck and shuffled the deck a few times along the way, you must admit that no one could know which cards lie here on the table."* Wait for your helper's confirmation.

In reality, you already know the top cards of the two tabled piles; in our example, they are the Five of Hearts and the King of Spades, which started on top of the deck. Due to the synchronization of words and actions, in addition to clever scripting and the subtle nature of the deception, hardly anyone will suspect that the statement you have just made isn't entirely true.

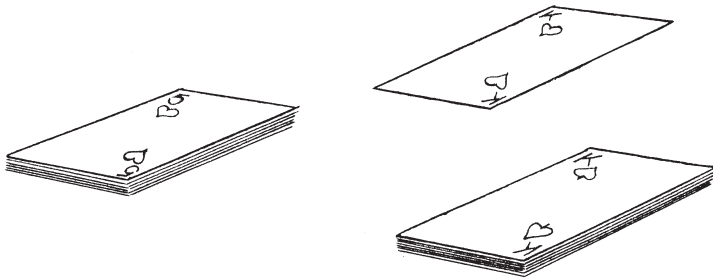
"Let's see which cards have randomly come to the top." Ask your helper to turn over the top card of one pile. It doesn't matter which; let's assume it is the Five of Hearts.

"This card gives us information about the suit. Since it is the Five of Hearts, the suit is hearts. Please turn the top card of the other pile face up." This will be our King of Spades.

"The King of Spades gives us information about the value, so it is a King. Hearts for the suit and King for the value gives us the King of Hearts. This is exactly what I saw in the future. So the future has become the present. And if that is true, I can

Back to the Future

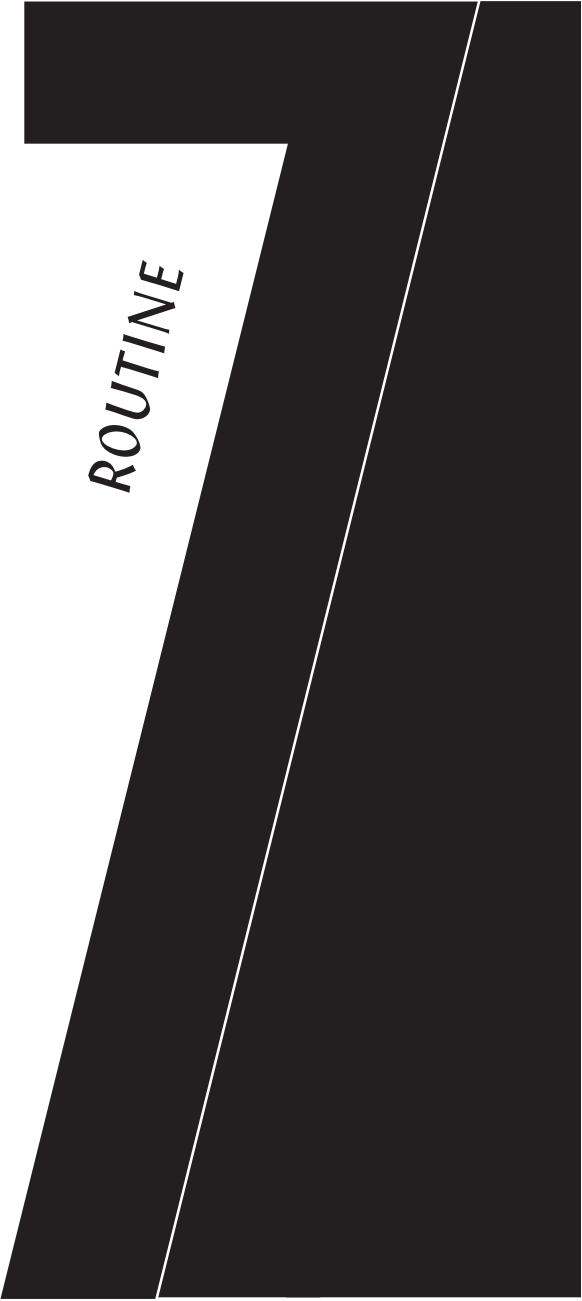
prove it with this card. And remember that I never touched the cards and that you have done everything yourself.” Allow your helper to turn the King of Hearts over himself, proving your claim correct. You can here deliver this concluding one-liner: “So we have proven that, in this instance, we have gone back to the future.”



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Lest I Forget...

1. In this trick, it is genuinely true that you have only to handle the cards very briefly in the beginning to make the effect possible. By all means, you should emphasize this hands-off condition, without mentioning, naturally, your initial handling of the cards. You can also underline this factor with body language, deliberately taking a few steps back from your helper and instructing him from a distance. This important detail leaves the audience with a lasting and vivid impression.
2. I always encourage that you create a completely different script that suits your personality. In any event, try to find a novel concept, so that your audience has more to remember than a mere prediction.

A large, bold, black number 7 is the central element of the image. The word "ROUTINE" is written in a black, serif, all-caps font, oriented vertically and centered within the upper loop of the number 7. The background is a solid, light gray.

ROUTINE

Manto

Y

ears ago, my friend Richard Vollmer from Strasbourg showed me this brilliant trick. It is based on a mathematical principle discovered by the supernaturally clever Bob Hummer.²⁰ This is somewhat different as card tricks go, in that no card is chosen; nevertheless, an audience member plays an active role in events.

Effect

The magician writes a prediction and places it inside the card case, which a spectator guards. An audience member and the performer mix the cards face up into face down, throwing the deck into a chaotic condition. Nonetheless, the prediction states how many cards lie face up and how many of those are black and how many red!

Props

Along with a deck of fifty-two cards, you will need a pen and a piece of paper for the prediction.

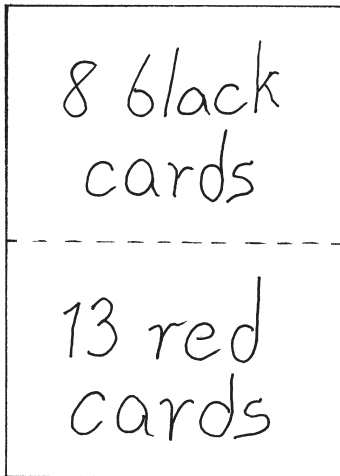
Preparation

Note and remember how many red and black cards lie among the top twenty-one cards of the deck. We'll assume there is a mix of eight black cards and thirteen reds. In addition, remember the twenty-first card from the top, which we'll nominate as the Queen of Diamonds.

Incidentally, this trick can also be performed impromptu. A method for doing this will be given in point 1 of the Lest I Forget section.

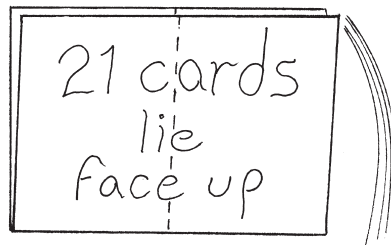
Staging and Handling

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Before you begin the effect proper, take out the paper and pen and announce that you will write a double prediction. In the middle of the paper write, "8 black cards, 13 red cards".

Fold the paper in half, with the writing inside, and write on the outside, "21 cards lie face up."

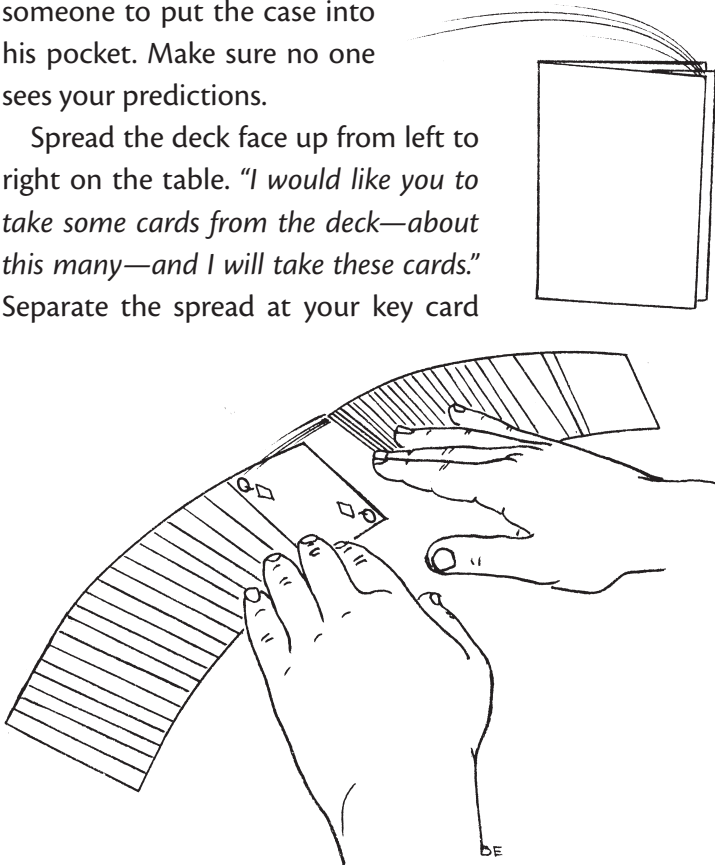


Fold the paper in half in the other direction, the fresh prediction folded inside (which later will be the first one read). Place the paper into the empty card case and ask

CARD COLLEGE LIGHT

someone to put the case into his pocket. Make sure no one sees your predictions.

Spread the deck face up from left to right on the table. *"I would like you to take some cards from the deck—about this many—and I will take these cards."* Separate the spread at your key card



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and give the top twenty-one cards to your elected helper, while you keep the rest for yourself. Use a free and relaxed attitude when making this separation, without staring at the deck, so that the dividing of the cards looks uncalculated and casual. The spectators must not suspect that you know the makeup or number of either portion.

Turn your part of the deck face down and thoroughly shuffle it, while having your helper to do the same with his cards.

Both of you next square your packets and set them face down on the table. You each then cut off a portion of your

pile, large or small, turn it face up and set it onto the face-down remainder of the other's pile. You both now shuffle your own parts of the deck again, mixing the face-up cards with the face-down ones. Square the packets and set them on the table.

Once again, both of you cut off a packet, turn it over and place it onto the other's portion of the deck. Then both of you shuffle your cards, square them and set them on the table.

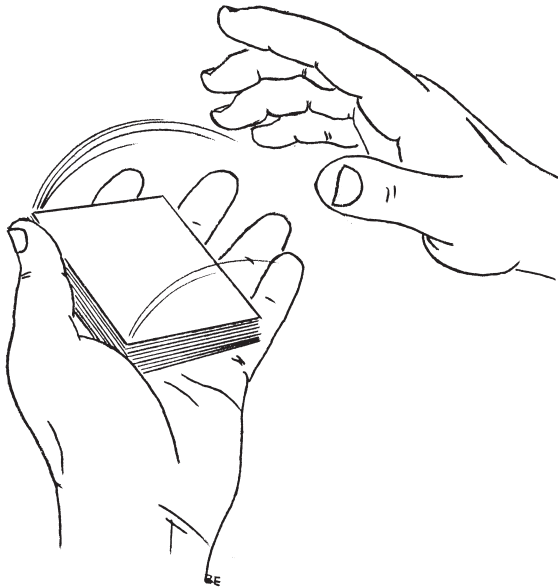
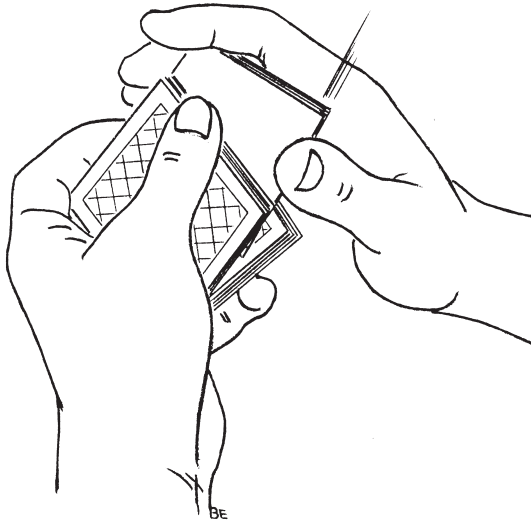
One last time you each cut off a packet from your own portion, turn it over and place it onto the other's packet. Throughout this process of mixing, which is in fact completely free, all you must make sure of is that your helper doesn't turn his packet over when he places it onto the table to cut off another portion. If this happens, just unob-

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trusively turn your packet over, too. Setting the two parts of the deck onto the table each time guarantees better control of the action and minimizes the risk of error.

Just as you did each time before, each of you shuffles your portion of the deck, which now contains an unknown number of face-down cards and face-up cards. As you complete an overhand shuffle of your packet, tip the upper edge of the packet to the left and into your left hand, which receives it in dealing position (see drawings opposite). This subtly turns your cards over, under cover of a completely natural action.

Ask your helper to set his cards onto the table, and you drop yours on top of them, reuniting the deck. He can now shuffle and cut the deck once again, until he is completely convinced that no one could know the order of the cards. Emphasize this fact. What you do not mention, though, is that it is the orientation of the cards; not their order that is important. And their orientation is not changed by either an



overhand shuffle or a riffle shuffle. To impress on everyone that you really have been shuffling the entire time, you could, while giving the cards a riffle shuffle, say something like *"Now we will shuffle once more, like the casino dealers do."*

M a n t o

Summarize: *"You must admit that the deck has been shuffled face up and face down more than completely. No one could know which cards are up and which are down, and no one could know how many of these there are. You cut your cards wherever you wanted, and you shuffled them yourself."* Your helper will hardly be able to deny this.

"Nevertheless, I have predicted the outcome." Hand the deck to your co-shuffler and request that he fan the cards and set all the face-up cards to one side. While he does this, count these face-up cards aloud and ask the rest of the group to count along. If everything has been done correctly, there should be exactly twenty-one cards.

134 Ask the person with the card case safe in his pocket to bring it out, remove your prediction, unfold the first fold of the paper and read your first prediction. It is correct—there are twenty-one cards!

Now have your helper separate the red cards from the blacks, forming two piles, and ask him to count the red cards aloud as he does this. Then have him count the black cards. He will count eight black cards and thirteen reds. When the person with your prediction reads the second part of it aloud, everyone will be astounded at your again knowing in advance the seemingly random makeup of the thoroughly mixed cards!

Lest I Forget...

1. If you wish to perform this trick impromptu, you can secretly note the twenty-first card in the course of doing "The Circus Card Trick" (page 67). You then only need to spread the deck face up from left to right on the table while you write your prediction.

While waiting for “inspiration”, you have enough time to count either the red or the black cards, whichever there are fewer of among the first twenty-one. You can usually estimate the less frequent color with a glance. It is best to begin with the twenty-first card, which, after all, you know, and count to the left end of the spread. As soon as you have this number (in our case eight black cards), subtract eight from twenty-one to get thirteen reds. These two numbers become your prediction. From here on, the trick continues as taught above. You can also fan the cards face up, so that the spectators can see them, under the pretext of showing that the cards are fairly and freely mixed, secretly counting one color as you make this display.

2. You can mark the twenty-first card with a corner crimp (see page 117) and note the number of red and black cards beforehand. Then give the deck a false shuffle that doesn’t change the order of the top twenty-one cards. Next, cut the face-down deck at the crimp. Your helper receives the top portion and you take the bottom one. This enhances the deception, since you don’t need to spread the cards face up.
3. While this description may seem a bit long, due to the necessary explanatory details, in performance it proceeds briskly. The trick calls for constant spectator-participation, which always increases interest. This piece belongs to a rather rare category of effects in card magic, since topological configurations play a part; nevertheless, this simple but striking trick doesn’t look at all like a mathematical puzzle.

Vernon's Miracle

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hose two words say it all. This trick is a creation of the Canadian master, Dai Vernon, the Professor, and is every bit as good as the title suggests.²¹

Effect

The magician finds a card selected under the fairest conceivable conditions.

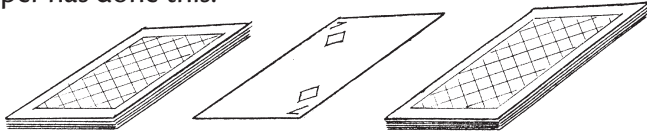
Staging and Handling

Hand the deck to someone for shuffling and cutting. Turn your back to the audience and give the following instructions: *"After you have shuffled the deck, place any card face up onto the table."* Let's say the card chosen is the Seven of Diamonds. *"Please lock this card in your memory. Now, to the left of your card, deal a number of cards equal to its value. For example, if you chose a Four, you would deal four cards into a pile; with a Five you would deal five, and so on. Aces will count as eleven."*

CARD COLLEGE LIGHT

Make sure a higher-valued spot card is selected. If a court card or a low spot card is taken, simply ask that a different card be chosen.

"Now deal exactly the same number of cards as you just did into a pile to the right of your card." Wait until your helper has done this.



"Take one of the two piles and shuffle it completely. When you have done this, place your chosen card face down on top of the packet and cut it one time. Set down that packet and pick up the second pile. Shuffle it just as thoroughly—and push the first pile into it at some spot."

Although these instructions may sound complicated, it doesn't matter at all whether your helper does something wrong. The instructions serve primarily to lure her (and possibly magicians, as well) down a false trail. You only need to make sure that she deals the correct number of cards into the two piles to the left and right of her selection. The remaining procedure, as you will see, is almost completely automatic.

Turn back to the spectators for the first time, since to this point you have been standing with your back to them. *"You know what? Before you give me the cards, please shuffle the whole packet once again very thoroughly."* By now even an informed spectator will wonder how you will find the card, since he will normally try to reconstruct how you could be guided by the *position* of the card. In fact, it is the *number* of cards that will give you information about the identity of the selection, a principle that is seldom used in card magic.

Vernon's Miracle

"Please think of your card. Yes, I believe I have it. To be completely sure, I will show you the cards once more. Please think of your card as soon as you see it." Make a point of looking away, and spread the cards with the faces toward your helper.

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As you are doing this, secretly count the cards—in our example, you will count exactly fifteen, since the chosen card was a Seven. Subtract one from the number you have counted and divide the result by two ($15 - 1 = 14$, and $14 \div 2 = 7$). You now know the value of the card.

The reason this works should be obvious: Your helper has dealt double the value of her card, plus the chosen

CARD COLLEGE LIGHT

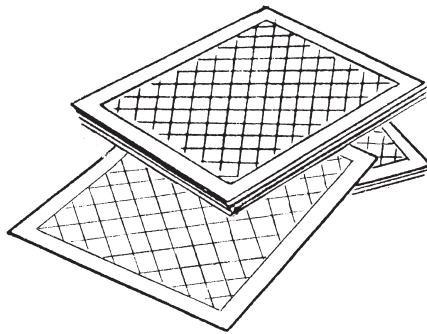
card itself. Although this seems quite obvious, the secret is well concealed by misleading presentation and the subsequent location.

You now know that your helper is thinking of a Seven. *"Yes, I see it very clearly."* This statement suggests that you have already guessed her card. In reality, you still have to figure out its suit! Spread the cards, faces toward you, and look for the Seven, which you set face down on the table in front of your helper.

Naturally, there may be more than one Seven in the packet. If this proves the case, bring one Seven to the top and one to the bottom. Then ask your helper to name the identity of her card and, depending on her answer, either turn over the top card or turn up the entire pile.

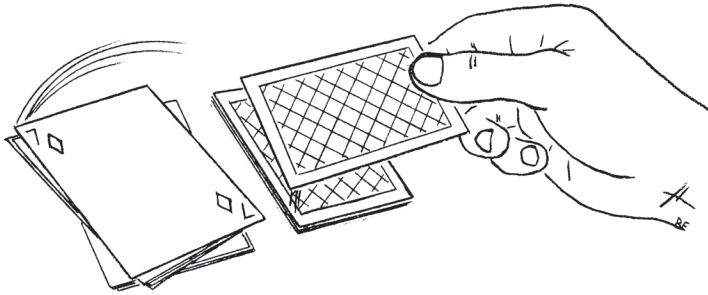
If there are three Sevens in the packet, bring one to the top, one to the bottom and place the third face down on the table. Remember which Seven is where. Cut the packet and mark the place by putting the Seven on the table diagonally between the two portions.

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Once again ask the name of the chosen card and react accordingly. If it is the card above the Seven left sticking out of the pile, say, *"And that is why I marked the deck exactly at your card."* While saying this, use the protruding Seven to flip

Vernon's Miracle



the upper portion face up, revealing the card at its face. If it is the protruding Seven itself, simply turn it over. And if it is the third Seven, separate the packet at the dividing Seven and turn the top card of the bottom portion face-up.

If you should find yourself in the unlikely position of having all four Sevens in the packet, you will have to “fish” for the selection as you are spreading through the cards. Your phrasing could sound something like this: “Yes, I have your card. It was a red card, wasn’t it?” If your helper agrees, bring one red Seven to the top and the other to the bottom, and proceed as described above for two cards, asking her to name her card in a loud, clear voice, and then revealing the appropriate top or bottom card. If your helper denies that her card is red, turn your statement into a gag by pointing to the red backs of the cards (assuming you are using a red-backed deck). “I hate to disagree with you, but all the cards in the deck are red.” But now you know that she chose one of the two black Sevens, so bring one to the top, the other to the bottom, and proceed as taught for the red Sevens.

That Is the Question

The following trick was shown to me by my imaginative friend in magic, Richard Vollmer. He took an ancient and well-known mathematical principle and dressed it in new clothes, which makes the modus operandi virtually impenetrable.

Effect

The magician asks no questions, yet he answers them while guessing and finding a freely and fairly thought-of card.

Staging and Handling

Have someone shuffle and cut the cards. Turn around and ask him to think of a number between ten and twenty. This done, have him deal that many cards one at a time from the top of the deck into a pile. Then have him hide the pile under the table mat or between his hands, giving you no way you can see how many cards he has dealt. Let's assume the number is seventeen.

That Is the Question

With the pile out of sight, you turn back to him and say, *"You have thought of a two-digit number. All magical numbers have only one digit. Therefore, I would like you to add the two digits of your number together to make a single-digit number. If you are thinking of twelve, you would add the one and the two to get three; if you are thinking of sixteen you would get seven, and so on."*

We are trying to avoid using the phrase "the sum of the digits," since that smells of a mathematical trick. Since the person helping in our working example has dealt seventeen cards, he will arrive at the number eight.

142 *"I will now show you about a dozen cards. Please remember the card that you see at your thought-of number."* Take the rest of the deck (your helper is still hiding his cards), show the top card, count "one" aloud and set this card face down on the table. Take the next card from the deck, show its face, count "two" and drop it face down onto the first card. Continue in this manner with the next eight cards. You have just dealt ten cards from the deck into a pile on the table, reversing their order in the process. Your helper has noted the eighth card you displayed, as he is thinking of eight. Let's say it is the Six of Hearts. Take this dealt pile and replace it on the deck.

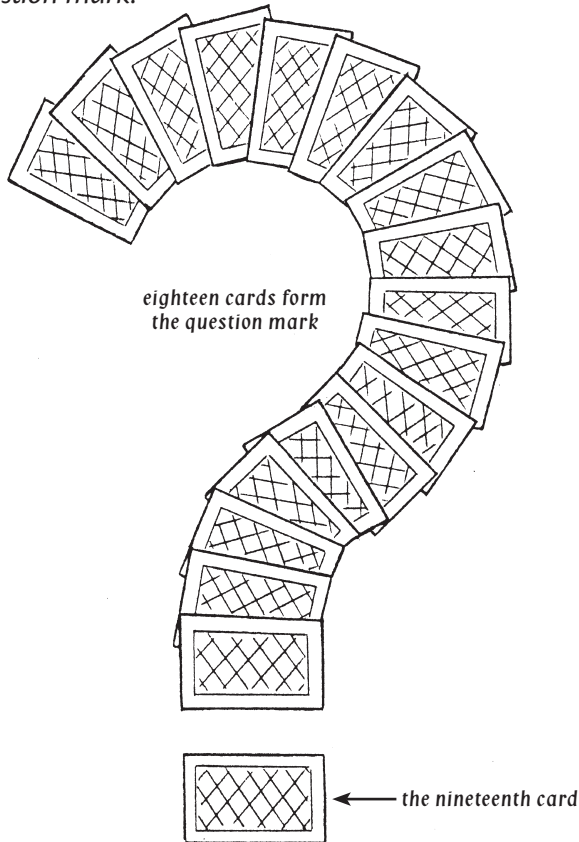
Now ask your helper to cut his packet into two packets, keeping one and giving you the other. Place this packet on top of the deck.

"You must admit that neither of us can know how many cards you gave me and how many you kept. We also cannot know where your thought-of card lies in the deck!" These two statements are true, but they are only half-truths that disguise the larger picture. We are behaving just like

CARD COLLEGE LIGHT

politicians before an election, except our motives are nobler and bear more pleasant consequences.

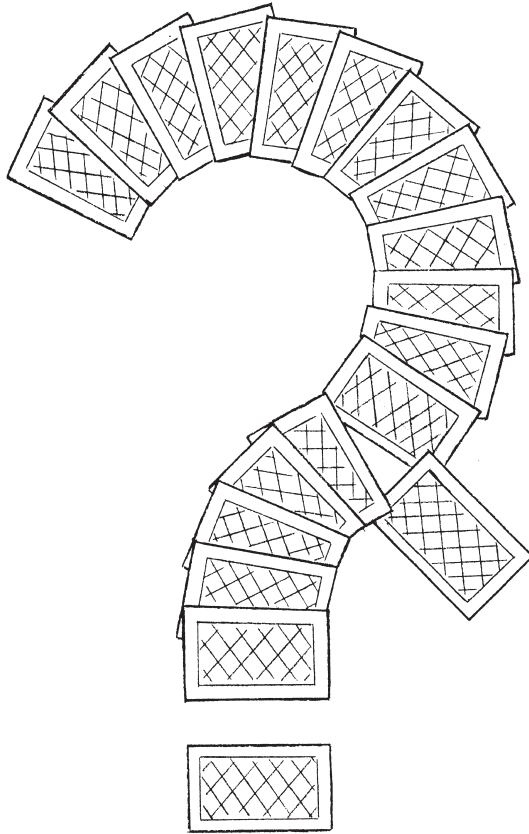
Deal the top nineteen cards from the deck onto the table, making a row of overlapping cards that form a question mark. The nineteenth card is the dot of the question mark. *"A question thus presents itself. Which is the card you are thinking of? The question is symbolically represented by this question mark."*



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"Now, for the first time, count the number of cards you have left." Your helper does this and finds, in our case, seven. Starting at the dot of the question mark, count to the

That Is the Question



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seventh card. Push this card face down toward your helper and state, *"If you had held onto four cards, we would have come to this card."* Point to the fourth card in the question mark. *"If you had kept ten, we would have come to this one."* Point again to the corresponding card. *"But we ended up exactly on the card there in front of you. Now, for the first time, please name in a loud, clear voice the card you are thinking of."* After he does this, have him slowly turn over the card in front of him. It is his thought-of card!

Afterword

*“Everything should be done as simply as possible,
but not more simply.”*

Albert Einstein

Dear Reader,

Every trick in this book can be performed without any sleight-of-hand at all—no glides, no double turnovers, not even the simplest double undercut. I have endeavored to make all explanations self-contained, so that you do not need to refer to information elsewhere to successfully perform the pieces described.

But perhaps you have read my Lest I Forget notes at the end of many of the tricks and have come to the conclusion that a few well-placed sleights can considerably increase the deceptiveness and power of some effects. For those of you who would like to expand your knowledge and try your hand at some more challenging and advanced card magic, I happily recommend the following titles, which are an introduction to the bright universe of card magic. Read them in the order given.

Roberto Giobbi, *Card College*, Hermetic Press, Seattle 1999–2004. This is a five-volume introduction into the techniques, themes and theories of the fine art of card

Afterword

magic. I suggest beginning with the first two volumes, which are a comprehensive introduction to the principles of card magic. No previous knowledge is required, and you are guided step by step through the fascinating world of card conjuring, accompanied by over five hundred illustrations. The principles are illustrated with top-flight card tricks. If you master the material in these two books alone, you can do more things with cards than ninety percent of the magicians who do card magic on this planet.

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Lewis Ganson, *Dai Vernon's Inner Secrets of Card Magic*, *Dai Vernon's More Inner Secrets of Card Magic*, *Dai Vernon's Further Inner Secrets of Card Magic* and *Dai Vernon's Ultimate Secrets of Card Magic*. These four books were originally published by Harry Stanley and Supreme Magic in England, and are now available from L&L Publishing in the USA. They contain some of the Professor's best creations, and each item is a masterful lesson in the art of card conjuring.

Frank Garcia, *Million Dollar Card Secrets*, New York, 1972; and *Super Subtle Card Miracles*, New York, 1973. These were the cult books of the 1970s. Excellent tricks from the repertoire of numerous pros, crisply described, ideal for studying, developing and performing.

Harry Lorayne, *Close-up Card Magic*, New York, 1962; and *Reputation Makers*, New York, 1971. These are engagingly written books, which will convey to you the author's enthusiasm for card magic. Both books contain excellent performance pieces.

Notes

1. First published in Spanish: Juan Tamariz, *Magia Potagia*, Vol. 3, Madrid, 1985. An English translation appeared some years later in Harry Lorayne's magazine *Apocalypse*, Vol. 10, No. 7, July 1987, page 1369. It was also published in English, under the title "Neither Blind Nor Silly", in Tamariz's book *Sonata*, Madrid, 1991, page 211.
2. "Red and Black", published in *Genii*, Vol. 52, No. 9, March 1989, page 560.
3. The coding method used here was first published by Howard Savage in the June 1929 issue of *The Sphinx*, Vol. 28, No. 4, p. 136. Mr. Savage's code was used in a book test using a booklet of poetry. The application of his code to playing cards seems to have been made by William McCaffrey (see John N. Hilliard's *Greater Magic*, 1938, page 566). This information was kindly supplied by Max Maven.
4. First published in *The Pallbearers Review*, Vol. 9, No. 5, March 1974, Teaneck, page 715.
5. The Hummer principle referred to is commonly known as CATO. We will be using the standard CATO procedure two tricks ahead. (Also see note 6 below.) While the handling used in "Royal Flush" is different from that

of the standard CATO procedure, the same parity principle is involved.

6. Murata marketed this location as a single-trick manuscript in 1945, under the name House of Magic, in Waikiki. This excellent control might have been forgotten, were it not for Eddie Fields's adaptation of it to a telephone trick, which was featured in *The Artful Dodges of Eddie Fields* by Jon Racherbaumer, New York, 1976, page 30.
7. Hummer published the first tricks using the CATO principle in a 1946 manuscript titled *Face Up Face Down Mysteries*.
8. The original McMillen trick, "The Mind Mirror", can be found in Hugard and Braue's *Expert Card Technique*, Minneapolis, 1940, page 223. And if you wish to explore the actual technique of muscle reading, good sources of information are Dariel Fitzkee's *Contact Mind Reading Expanded*, Oakland, 1935; Robert A. Nelson's *Hellstromism*, Calgary, 1945; Chapter 5 of *The Mental Mysteries and Other Writings of William W. Larsen, Sr.*, Los Angeles, 1977; and *Corinda's Thirteen Steps to Mentalism*, New York, 1968, page 50. An easily understood article on the theory and practical application of muscle reading can also be found in Martin Gardner's *Encyclopedia of Impromptu Magic*, Chicago, 1978, page 392. This book is in general so good, I will simply recommend it without reservation.
9. The principle was first recorded by C. O. Williams in Stan-
yon's *Magic*, Vol. 13, No. 12, Sept. 1913, page 100, item 14. Charles Jordan elaborated on it in his booklet, *Thirty Card Mysteries*, 1919, page 7 of the second edition.

10. This subtle force was first published by Max Holden in Bagshawe's *The Magical Monthly*, Vol. 2, No. 10, July 1925, page 199.
11. Descriptions of this trick can be found in several sources, among them in Hugard and Braue's *Royal Road to Card Magic*, New York, 1949, page 150.
12. The basic version of this trick, which includes the use of the "Circus Card Trick" as a method of setting up, first appeared in Hugard and Braue's *Expert Card Technique: "The Twenty-sixth Location"*, New York, 1940, page 397. Very recently, David Ben, the Canadian professional, discovered in correspondence evidence that places this trick (like so much of the uncredited material in *Expert Card Technique*) at Dai Vernon's door. The presentational premise of fingerprints that we use in this effect is borrowed from another trick that Vernon performed for many years, "The Fingerprint Card Trick" in *The Vernon Chronicles, Volume One* by Stephen Minch, Tahoe, 1987, page 136.
13. Apart from a few personal modifications, I have taken the handling explained directly from *Greater Magic* by John Northern Hilliard: "A Matter of Debit and Credit", Minneapolis, 1938, page 157; a reprint was published in 1994 by Kaufman and Greenberg. This book is without doubt one of the great works of magic's literature, and I highly recommend a careful study of it. The section on card magic is excellent. According to Paul Stadelman, in his 1934 booklet *Sandu Writes Again* (Hopkinsville, KY, page 5), the second phase of this routine is the idea of R. W. Hull. (My thanks to Max Maven for pointing out this reference.)

Notes

14. See "Would I Lie to You?" in Mike Maxwell's *The Commercial Magic of J. C. Wagner*, Tahoe, 1987, page 141.
15. I first learned the Card at Any Number trick in *El Prestidigitador Optimus* by Joaquin Partagas: "La carta en el bolsillo", page 42. However, the trick appears in much earlier works, such as *Ein Spiel Karten* by R. P., published in Prague in 1853. The effect is this: Placing the deck into his pocket, the magician asked someone to name any number. He counted down in the deck to the number requested, removing the cards one by one, and produced a previously chosen card at the specified number. The secret was deceptively simple: The selection was controlled to the top of the deck, and all the cards counted were taken from the bottom, until the chosen number was reached. When I read this, I immediately saw an excellent opportunity for a deck switch. Later, I learned that Al Baker had long before pioneered the general idea of accomplishing a deck switch under the pretext of openly placing the deck into a pocket as part of the presentation for another effect. Baker first described this idea in one of ten tricks making up an exclusive manuscript sold by him in the 1920s for the then extraordinary price of \$25.00. It was later included by Jean Hugard in *Encyclopedia of Card Tricks*, New York, 1937, page 190; see the fourth method for "Switching the Deck". It can also be found in *The Secret Ways of Al Baker*, Seattle, 2003, page 467.
16. See "Another Spectator Cuts the Aces" in Marlo's *The Unexpected Card Book*, Chicago, 1974, page 209.
17. A version of the trick very similar to that taught here was first contributed by Cervon to Charlie Miller's

famous “Magicana” column in *Genii* magazine, Vol. 50, No. 8, February 1987, page 577. Cervon’s trick was in turn inspired by another Vernon protégé, Harry Riser, in the same magazine, four issues earlier.

18. *Super Subtle Card Miracles*, New York, 1973; see “Convention Card Location”, page 130.
19. See “The Spectator Does a Trick” in Leech’s *Cardmanship*, Chicago, 1959, page 6. Leech seems to have been the first to conceive of this double-dealing principle.
20. Called the “cancellation combination principle” or the “self-cancellation principle”, it first appeared in “Face Up Prediction”, a trick included in Bob Hummer’s *Half a Dozen Hummers*, Chicago, 1940. Simon Aronson’s “Shuffle-bored” (published in a monograph of the same name, Chicago, 1980) is the best-known trick using the principle. My version is based on a trick called “Topsy-turvy”, first published in Richard Vollmer’s *Antologie des tours automatiques*, Strasbourg, 1986, page 90.
21. I recorded this trick, ascribed to Vernon, years ago in one of my notebooks, and have since been unable to locate the source where I originally read it.

